

Building a SMART Goal

Narrator:

Welcome back! Today, we'll talk about goals and how to create a goal using the SMART technique.

Let's start by talking about what **outcome and process goals** are.

- **Outcome goals** are goals that focus on a desired result, like losing weight or landing your dream job.
- The challenge with outcome goals is that they don't take into account **the effort and the time required** to achieve them. **Since they often take a while to accomplish, it's easy to lose motivation if progress isn't immediate.** That's why it's important to shift our focus from outcome goals to **process goals**.

Narrator:

Process goals are goals that focus on the **specific actions** needed to help you reach your desired outcome. By breaking the goal into actionable steps, you can celebrate small victories along the way!

Research on behavior change shows that one of the best ways to set process goals is by using what's called **S.M.A.R.T. goals**.

Narrator:

What is a SMART Goal? Well, SMART stands for **Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Realistic, and Time-based**. Let's build a SMART goal together as we go through each step!

- **S – which stands for Specific:** Or in another words What exactly do you want to accomplish?
 - Suppose we want to set a goal related to physical activity. Instead of saying, "I want to be more active," we **make it specific** by saying, **"I want to increase my daily step count."**
- **M – Measurable:** How will you track your progress?
 - A goal needs to be **quantifiable** so we can determine if we've achieved it. Measurement can be based on time like exercising for 30 minutes, repetitions like , five or 10 sets of sit-ups, or frequency like working out three times a week.
 - **To make our example more specific, instead of saying, "I want to increase my daily step count.", we might say, "I want to increase my daily step count to 5,000 steps."**
- Alright, Let's move on to **A – which stands for Attainable:** Is the goal attainable for your current skill level or experience?
 - If you haven't exercised in a while, setting a goal to **run three miles** may not be as attainable as starting with **a daily 30-minute walk**. It's important to set goals based on **what your body and your surroundings allow**.

Narrator:

• So, looking back at our example, we wanted to increase our daily step count to 5,000 steps. But let's say we check our average steps per day on our fitness tracker or our phone, it looks like we get around 3,000 steps. Well, then we may want to adjust our goal to be more attainable. How do we do that? Well, instead of aiming for 5,000 daily steps, let's aim to increase our step count to let's say 4,000 steps.

- Alright, Lets' keep moving. **R – Realistic:** So, Does this goal fit your lifestyle and current circumstances?

- Look, Life happens! Unexpected events, work, family responsibilities, or even the weather can impact our ability to follow through with our goals.

- For example, if the forecast predicts rain all week, increasing our step count by 1,000 steps might not be realistic. Instead, we can adjust our goal to 3,500 steps per day, making it more realistic.

- And lastly, **T stands for Time-bound:** When will you accomplish this goal?

- Research shows that setting a time frame helps keep us accountable.

- In our example, we set a daily step goal for one week. But depending on your goal, you might choose a different structure—like strength training every Tuesday and Thursday.

Narrator:

Well done! Now that you know how to set a SMART goal, Let's go over some tips to set yourself up for success:

- **Tip # 1. Plan for “Rain or Shine.”**
 - Look, Life is full of surprises! Work, family, or weather can change what we can or feel like doing. Setting a humble goal ensures you can still follow through, even when times get tough
- **Tip #2. Keep goals positive and take ownership.**
 - Instead of saying, “I have to walk three times this week,” reframe it as, “I will go on three walks this week to keep my heart healthy and strong.”
- **and Tip #3. Align your goals with your values.**
 - Values are the fuel that keep you going, even when motivation fades. Make sure your goals reflect what truly matters to you.

Narrator:

Alright, keep in mind, the ultimate goal is to **achieve** your goals! Science shows that meeting our goals is linked to positive emotions, making it easy to build lasting habits.

Now get out there, and set some SMART goals to help you become the best version of yourself!

Animation #1 – Lifestyle Recommendations for Cancer Prevention and Survivorship

Animation link: <https://vimeo.com/1029667384/71a012bcce?share=copy>

- In this video, we will discuss the three lifestyle recommendations for cancer prevention and survivorship. **And the good news is that these lifestyle recommendations are no different for anyone who wants to improve their health.**
- Did you know that almost half of cancer diagnoses and deaths are preventable by engaging in healthy behaviors?
 - Show: **40% of cancer cases** and about **45% of cancer deaths** in the US are attributed to potentially modifiable risk factors.
 - [Second Cancer Risks Related to Lifestyle and Environment | American Cancer Society](#)
- The American Cancer Society and the American Institute of Cancer Research have set lifestyle recommendations that have been shown to prevent cancer, reduce symptoms, and improve health and quality of life. Amazing right? You probably don't want to miss out on these, so let's review them together. The first recommendation is to be physically active.
- Adults should engage in 150 minutes of moderate-intensity activity, including things like brisk walking, yoga, and leisurely biking.
- And if you are short on time, you can do 75 minutes of vigorous-intensity activity, including running, swimming, and singles tennis.
- And feel free to mix and match to your liking. All you have to remember is that one minute of vigorous-intensity activity equals two minutes of moderate; remember, the goal is to get 150 minutes of moderate.
- Adults should also engage in muscle-strengthening activities, also known as strength training, two or more days per week and include using things like hand weights, exercise bands, or body-weight activities, which include squats or push-ups.
- The second recommendation is to follow a healthy eating pattern.
- Eating nutritious foods can help cancer survivors manage their energy levels, feel better, and stay stronger.
- So, let's break this down into four food groups you should eat and four you should limit or avoid entirely.
- **First, eat foods high in nutrients and in amounts that help achieve and maintain healthy body weight.**
- **Second, eat vegetables in various colors, the more colors, the better!**
- So think of foods like green spinach, red peppers, and orange sweet potatoes. And don't forget about fiber-rich legumes like beans and peas.
- **Third, eat WHOLE fruits in various colors, like strawberries, peaches, and bananas.**
- **Fourth, eat whole grains like brown rice, popcorn, and whole wheat tortillas.**
- **Now, let's talk about the four food groups we should limit or avoid entirely.**
- **First, limit or avoid eating red meats such as beef, lamb, or pork and processed meats like bacon or deli meats.**
- **Second, limit or avoid consuming sugar-sweetened beverages, including soft, sports, or coffee drinks.**
- **Third, avoid eating ultra-processed foods and refined grain products.** Ultra-processed foods include things like chips, hot dogs, frozen meals, and breakfast cereals. Refined grains include white rice or most white breads.
- **Fourth, limit alcohol.** Alcohol has been linked to several cancers.
- So far, we've talked about the energy we spend by being active and the energy we consume by eating. Both of these behaviors are tied to the **third recommendation, which states that we should aim to achieve and maintain a healthy weight**, and avoid obesity.
- Losing weight is not easy, many things can make it hard to eat healthy and stay active. And so, in the US, one out of three Americans is obese, and another one out of three is overweight, *placing two out of three Americans at risk for negative health outcomes*. But not to worry, we're here to help.
- Great job! That concludes the review of lifestyle recommendations for cancer prevention and survivors. I know that was a lot! But don't worry. We'll provide resources to help you find what works for you.

Animation #2 - Additional Cancer Recommendations for Cancer Survivors

Animation link: <https://vimeo.com/1029666489/07bc862cb1?share=copy>

In this video, we will discuss why it's important to assess your diet and physical activity, as these are two recommendations specific to cancer survivors.

- **The first recommendation is that** survivors should begin a nutritional assessment and counseling as soon as possible after being diagnosed with the goal of:
 - First, to prevent or resolve nutrient deficiencies.
 - Second, to preserve muscle mass
 - And third, to manage side effects of treatments that may adversely affect nutritional status.
- If your healthcare team determines that you're at risk for malnutrition or have other diet-related issues that could affect your nutritional status, they should refer you to a Registered Dietitian Nutritionist (also called RDN) or Registered Dietitian (RD) for personalized nutritional counseling.
- Both during and after cancer treatment, survivors who aren't having problems with malnutrition or nutrition-related side effects should follow the healthy dietary patterns recommended by the ACS
- Many dietary patterns can fit within these general guidelines, including the Mediterranean diet, a vegetarian or mostly plant-based diet, or even the US Dietary Guidelines for Americans.
- **Now to the second recommendation:** survivors should begin a **physical activity** assessment and counseling as soon as possible after cancer is diagnosed. With the goal of:
 - First, to help patients prepare for treatments,
 - Second, to tolerate and respond to treatments,
 - And third, manage some cancer-related symptoms and side effects.
- Why is this important? Well, being physically active after a cancer diagnosis can help improve survival for breast, colorectal, and prostate cancer survivors, and the evidence is growing that it can be helpful for some other cancers as well.
- Physical activity can also help reduce anxiety, depression, fatigue, lymphedema, and improve health-related quality of life, physical function, bone health, and sleep.
- Because of the many benefits of physical activity, the American Cancer Society recommends that physical activity assessment and counseling begin as soon as possible after cancer is diagnosed. And being physically active is safe for most people getting cancer treatment. However, it's still important for people to check in with their care team before starting any exercise program for advice on choosing a safe and effective program.

How much should we eat? Serving Sizes

Welcome back!

Today, we're diving into a topic that can make a big difference in your health: serving sizes! Understanding how much of each food group you should be eating each day is key to building a balanced diet. In this video, we'll:

1. Review the recommended serving sizes for an average 2,000-calorie diet.
2. Share a quick trick to estimate serving sizes on the go.
3. Discuss factors that can influence how much food you should be eating.

[ANIMATOR NOTE: Three bullet points
Influencing Factors]

1. Recommended Serving Sizes; 2. Quick Portion Tricks; 3.

Let's get started!

[ANIMATOR NOTE: Chapter 1: Serving Sizes Overview]

For an adult following a 2,000-calorie diet, the **Dietary Guidelines for Americans** recommend:

- **For fruits:** Aim for **2 cups per day**. *Include a variety of fresh, frozen, or canned options to keep things interesting.*
- **For vegetables:** Strive for **2½ cups daily**. *Try to mix green, red, orange, and starchy veggies for maximum nutrition.*
- **For protein Foods:** Include **5½ ounces** of *lean protein daily*. *Great options include poultry, fish, eggs, beans, and nuts.*
- **And for Grains:** Aim for **6 ounces per day**, *with at least half from whole grains like oatmeal, brown rice, or whole-grain bread.*

[ANIMATOR NOTE: Quick Tricks for Estimating Serving Sizes]

Now, how can you estimate these amounts without lugging around measuring cups? Easy—use your hands! Let's break it down:

- **For fruits and vegetables,** 1 cup is roughly the size of your closed fist. You'll want around 2 closed fist portions for fruits, and two and a half for vegetables.
- **For proteins:** A 3-ounce serving is about the size of your palm. You'll need about two palm-sized portions.
- **And for grains:** 1 ounce is approximately the size of your cupped hand. You'll aim for six cupped-hand portions.

See? Your hands are a built-in portion guide. Handy, right?

[ANIAMTOR NOTE: Chapter 3: Factors Influencing Your Needs]

Of course, serving sizes are just a general guide. Your specific needs depend on a variety of factors, including:

- Your **sex**
- Your **age** and stage of life.
- Your **activity level**—more movement means more energy is required.
- Your **weight goal**—whether you’re aiming to maintain, lose, or gain weight.
- Any **health conditions** like diabetes, heart disease, or cancer which might require adjustments to your diet.

[Closing Reminder]

Remember, serving sizes aren’t a one-size-fits-all rule. Your needs may vary, and that’s okay! The best approach? Work with a dietitian to tailor your diet to your unique goals and health needs.

Thanks for joining me today, and here’s to healthier eating—one serving at a time!

Animation #11 – How to Build a Healthy Plate

Animation link: <https://vimeo.com/1029661732/c43b18b016?share=copy>

Narrator: Hey there! In this video, we're going to show you how to build a healthy plate in five easy steps.

These tips are aligned with the recommendations for cancer prevention and survivorship. Let's get started

Narrator:

Step 1. The first step is about focusing on improvement, NOT perfection.

Perfection is hard to achieve and can lead to feeling disappointed. Improvement is more **doable** because it's about getting better bit by bit. It means you're always **learning** and **growing**, even when things don't go perfectly. When you're focused on improvement, you're more **open** to trying new things and **adapting** to changes. So if you remember anything, remember to focus on improvement, because there's not such thing as perfection!

- Now that we're all on the same page, let's shift the focus on building our plate.
- I want you to think of your plate as having three sections, fruits and veggies, proteins, and grains.
- Let's tackle the first section.

Step 2. Fruits and vegetables. Aim to make half of your plate fruits and vegetables.

- Variety is key here, so the more colors, the better. Focus on vegetables like broccoli, crunchy carrots, or red radishes
- And colorful fruits such as purple grapes, red cherries, blueberries, and juicy green apples.
- Now that half of our plate is done, let's keep moving.

Step 3. Proteins. Aim for ¼ of the plate to include healthy proteins!

- Whether you are vegan, vegetarian, or are a meat-lover, the options are endless, '
- You can choose between lean meats like chicken or turkey, fish like salmon or cod, or hearty legumes like kidney beans, tofu, or nuts
- Three steps down, two to go!

Step 4. Whole Grains.

- The last ¼ of your plate should be grains, and half of that should be whole grains like oats, quinoa, and brown rice.
- A whole grain is a product where the first ingredient on the label is a whole grain such as whole wheat, whole wheat flour, whole oats, whole barley, brown rice, or quinoa to name a few.
- So keep these in mind the next time you're in the market for some bread, pasta, or cereals.

On to the last step! **Step 5: Drink Water.**

- While the options are endless in what we can drink, it's often best to drink water while we eat.
- Water helps your body
 - Stay hydrated and working well.
 - Digest foods and prevent constipation,

- keeps our skin healthy and moisturized
- and helps manage our weight, by reducing our appetite before meals.

Since our bodies are mostly water, staying hydrated isn't just important—it's essential for feeling our best and keeping everything running smoothly.

- Well, that does it! We've finished learning how to build a healthy plate. Now, get out there and build your own!

Aligning Values with Action

Living with Purpose

[Opening Scene]

(Warm visuals of cancer survivors and caregivers engaging in meaningful activities—walking together, cooking, journaling. Soft music plays.)

Narrator:

Welcome back! In this video we are going to talk about the idea of aligning our actions with our values. Life after a cancer diagnosis is a journey—one that extends beyond treatment into daily life. Many survivors and caregivers want to be more active, they want to eat healthier, and take better care of themselves. But it can be hard—things like fatigue, work, family responsibilities, and self-doubt—can all get in the way.”

“So how do we make healthy behavior changes, when things are hard?”

[A Different Way to Approach Change]

(A character stands at a crossroads—one path leading toward habits like scrolling on the couch, another toward an active, engaged life. They pause, then take a small step toward the meaningful path.)

Narrator:

Well, one way is aligning our actions or behaviors with what we value. Research shows that when our actions or everyday behaviors align with what truly matters to us or in another word our values—we experience greater well-being. People who make choices based on their values see improvements in mental health, things like reduced anxiety and depression, and are more likely to engage in healthy behaviors like physical activity and healthy eating—even in difficult moments.” [\(Sources\)](#) [\(Sources\)](#)

“**This way of thinking is often called Acceptance and Commitment Therapy, or ACT.** It’s a well-supported approach that helps people accept difficult emotions and situations, step back from unhelpful thoughts, and take meaningful action.”

[Exploring Values: Living by What Matters]

(Words appear on screen: “Health,” “Family,” “Independence,” “Spirituality,” “Joy.” The camera zooms in on a character reflecting on their value of ‘health.’)

Narrator:

So how we do this? The first step is **identifying your values, or in other words, what truly matters to you.** *[Add sentence on what potential values could be, playing with grandkids.]*

- For example, someone who values health may want to be more active but struggles with motivation.”

(Scene transition: The character plans to exercise but hesitates—“I’m too tired.” Instead of giving up, they acknowledge the thought and take a small step forward.)

Narrator:

“And this is a normal feeling . Instead of waiting to ‘feel motivated,’ you can choose to act in line with your values.”

“Instead of saying, ‘I need to feel motivated to exercise,’ try, something like ‘I will move because my health matters to me.’”

[Taking Small, Meaningful Steps]

(Visuals of people engaging in small, realistic health behaviors—stretching at home, taking a short walk, adding a vegetable to their plate.)

Narrator:

Look, “Change doesn’t happen overnight. It happens in small, meaningful steps.”

“Even when it’s uncomfortable, each action—whether it’s a five-minute walk or choosing a balanced meal—or an extra piece of fruit, all of this reinforces the life you want to live.”

(Visual of the character walking with a friend, reinforcing how values-driven actions become habits over time.)

[Final Encouragement]

(A diverse group of cancer survivors and caregivers engaged in healthy activities, with uplifting music.)

Narrator:

“Survivorship isn’t just about managing symptoms—it’s about creating a life with intention, one that reflects your values”

“You don’t have to be perfect, or do it all at once. You just have to take one step at a time.”

(Closing message appears: “Take action for what matters most.” The screen fades to the program’s logo.)

Move Smarter, Not Harder: Fitness Backed by Science

Narrator: *Hey there! Today, we're going to review some science-backed tips that will help you get moving. Because there's no one exercise that will magically melt belly fat or no single trick to get you ripped overnight. Sustainable fitness is built on consistency, movement, and small daily wins.*

So, let's go over some techniques that will help you move smarter, not harder.

Behavior Change Techniques That Work to Move More

Narrator:

1. Start Small, Build Up

[Do not narrate: ([Graded Tasks - BCT #8.7](#))]

Going all-in on day one often leads to burnout. Try starting with something doable—maybe just 5 minutes of movement a day. It's not about doing the most; it's about doing it again tomorrow. Consistency beats intensity in the long run.

2. Set SMART Goals and Problem Solve

[Do not narrate: ([Goal Setting - BCT #1.1](#) and [Action Planning - BCT #1.4](#))]

A vague goal like 'I want to be fit' won't get you far. Instead, set yourself up for success with SMART goals—Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Realistic, and Time-based. The clearer your goal, the higher your chances of achieving it!

But let's be real—obstacles will come up. A well-defined goal isn't just a target; it's a roadmap! When challenges arise, having a clear direction helps you adapt, problem-solve, and stay on track.

3. Track Your Progress

[Do not narrate: ([Feedback on Behavior - BCT #2.2](#))]

What gets measured gets managed. Whether it's writing down your workouts or using a fitness app, smartwatch, or fitness tracker, keeping a record of your progress keeps you motivated and accountable. Small wins add up!

4. Learn by Doing: Watch, Practice, Improve

[Do not narrate: ([Modeling - BCT #6.1](#) & [Behavioral Practice - BCT #8.1](#))]

Watching and practicing movements improves technique and helps build habits. Follow a trainer, a friend, or our guided exercise series to master movements safely. Check out our instructional videos for proper form on foundational exercises.

5. Social Support: Move With a Friend

Having a workout buddy or signing up for workout classes keeps you engaged, accountable, and makes movement fun. Support matters.

6. Find Your Why: Align Values with Action

[Do not narrate: ([Info about Health Consequences - BCT #5.1](#) & [ACT Principles](#))]

Knowing why you're exercising boosts adherence. Is it to have more energy? To be a better role model? To reduce disease risk? Or to feel confident in your body? Exercise reduces disease risk, enhances mood, and improves quality of life. When your 'why' is strong, your motivation follows.

Narrator:

The Secret to Success is Just Keep Showing Up

The goal isn't to be the fastest or the strongest—it's to show up again tomorrow. If today's workout was just stretching or a short walk, that's a win.

The key isn't winning today—it's making sure you're ready for tomorrow. Fitness isn't about perfection; it's about progress. It's a journey, not a test. Small, consistent steps will lead to big changes over time.

Keep moving, and fitness will take care of itself.

Animation #7 – Movement is Life

Get Ready to Move!

Human beings like us were built to move! We're designed to run, squat, crawl, and lift as part of our daily lives. But as technology has evolved, so have our habits, and it's now easier than ever to forget to move. In this video, we'll break down how much we need to move based on the Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans

So, lace up those shoes, and let's get started—because what you're about to learn might just inspire you to get moving!

- **First Things First: Safety!**

Before starting any new exercise routine, check in with your doctor to make sure it's safe for you. Now, let's get into the recommended activities!

- **The Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans** recommend **two** key types of physical activities:

1. ****Aerobic Activity**** (often called “cardio”)
2. ****Muscle-Strengthening Activity**** (or resistance training)

In this video, we'll focus on the aerobic activity recommendations.

- **How Much Cardio Should You Do?**

Adults should aim for ****150 minutes of moderate-intensity aerobic activity per week****.

- **What's moderate intensity?****

A good rule of thumb is that you should be able to talk but not sing while doing these activities. Think of things like brisk walking, dancing, hiking, gardening, or a casual bike ride.

If 150 minutes sounds like a lot, don't worry—you can cut it in half with ****75 minutes of vigorous-intensity activity**** per week!

- **What's vigorous intensity?**

If you can only say a few words without catching your breath, you're likely doing vigorous activity. Examples include swimming laps, carrying heavy loads, going for a run, or playing singles tennis.

- **Breaking It Down**

If 150 minutes seems tough to fit in, remember that you can break it up however works best for you!

- Try 10 minutes in the morning, 10 in the afternoon, and 10 in the evening on weekdays.
- Or go for longer sessions, like 60 minutes on Monday, 60 minutes on Wednesday, and 30 minutes on Saturday.

The key is to find what works best for your schedule.

- **Here are Five Quick Tips to Get Started**

1. ****Start Slow****: Ease into your routine to create positive experiences. Doing too much too soon can lead to burnout.
2. ****Be Consistent****: Regular activity builds habits. Set realistic goals, and include rest days or focus on different muscle groups after tough workouts.
3. ****Choose Fun Activities****: Enjoying what you do makes it easier to stick with your routine.

4. ****Invite a Friend****: Exercising with friends or joining a group can provide support, motivation, and accountability.
5. ****Focus on Your Progress****: Don't compare yourself to others. Your journey is about your growth, and that's what counts!

Take-Home Message

Any movement is better than none, so even if you can't reach 150 minutes, just get moving!

Sources:

- [exercise-intensity-infographic.pdf \(acsm.org\)](#)
- [Examples of Moderate and Vigorous Physical Activity | Obesity Prevention Source | Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health](#)
- [ACSM's General Exercise Guidelines \(etsu.edu\)](#)

Feel Better Today: Short -Term Benefits of Exercise

Final Script: Feel Better, Sooner—Together

Narrator: Hey! In today's video, we'll explore how exercise can help you feel better—sooner rather than later.

Whether you're navigating cancer recovery or supporting someone who is, you both carry a lot.

Tired all the time. Stressed. Not sleeping well. It's a lot to handle.

But here's the good news:

To improve many of the most common symptoms, you don't need a gym.

You don't need fancy equipment either.

You just need to move your body—regularly.

Physical activity can help ease 8 common symptoms experienced by cancer survivors, let's dive in and learn more about the benefits.

[Scene 2: “The Power of Aerobic Activity” | Couple walking together outside]

Narrator: To improve symptoms like fatigue, health-related quality of life, physical function, anxiety, depression and sleep, it's simple, just aim for 30 to 60 minutes of aerobic activity, 3 times per week.

Again, you don't have to climb a mountain. A walk around the neighborhood, dancing in the kitchen, or following along with a workout video works just as well.

[Scene 3: Split screen – Caregiver looking anxious | Survivor rubbing temples]

Narrator: Aerobic activity can help lift your mood and ease stress. And sometimes, the best therapy is a walk-and-talk with someone you love, or letting the wind hit your face while you breathe a little deeper.

[Scene 4: Survivor getting up from a chair, caregiver helping with groceries]

Narrator: It's important to keep in mind that regular movement builds energy and strength. Which makes simple, daily tasks a little easier—like carrying a laundry basket or reaching for that mug on the top shelf. Remember – if you don't use it, you lose it!

[Scene 5: Bedroom at night – tossing and turning | Morning walk scene]

Narrator: 🌞 Aerobic activity even helps you fall asleep faster and sleep more soundly through the night.

So you might find that, instead of counting sheep, you're drifting off with fewer aches and a little more peace.

[Scene 6: Couple walking | Text: “30–60 minutes. 3x per week.”]

Narrator: Just 30 to 60 minutes of movement, three times a week can ease symptoms and help you feel better overall—what we call your health-related quality of life.

And when you feel better, everything—from conversations to cooking dinner—feels just a little lighter.

[Scene 7: Home setting – couple using resistance bands or light weights]

Narrator: So, we reviewed benefits of *aerobic* activity, now let's switch gears to resistance or strength training. And strength training can help improve lymphedema and even bone health.

Let's review what's recommended: Twice a week, work your major muscle groups with two sets of 8 to 15 repetitions using light weights or bands.

That might mean lifting soup cans or doing a few wall push-ups. Strength doesn't have to be intense—it just has to be steady.

[Closing Scene: App interface | Couple smiling post-exercise]

Narrator: That's a quick look at how movement can help manage the most common symptoms—right from your home, and with the support of someone by your side.

Small, consistent steps can spark big changes—like more energy for family time, or fewer aches during your favorite TV show.

Check out our other animations and follow-along videos in the app—and start moving today.

[On-screen tagline: “Move. Support. Thrive. Together.”]

Nutrition Facts: Learning the Labels

Narrator:

Welcome! Do you ever wonder what's in the food you eat? In this video, we'll teach you how to read food labels in **five easy steps** so you can take control of what you eat—and pick foods that align with **YOUR health goals**.

[Transition FOR ANIMATOR: List of 5 Steps appears on-screen, check mark after each is completed]

- **1: Serving Information**
- **2: Calories**
- **3: Nutrients to Limit**
- **4: Nutrients to Increase**
- **5: Added Sugars**

Narrator:

Let's begin with step 1, the **serving information**. You can find this at the top of the food label. You'll see:

1. **Servings per container:** These are the total number of servings in the package and
2. **Serving size:** This is the amount of food in **one serving**.

Narrator:

Keep in mind—serving sizes can vary widely depending on the product, so always double-check!

Narrator:

For example, let's take a look at the nutritional label of this bag of nacho chips. As you can see, it contains a total of **15 servings**, and each serving is equal to **12 chips**. And remember this can change; for example, let's take a look at this bag of tortilla chips, which includes a total of **5 servings**, and each serving equals **14 chips**. Now we know how to find out how many servings are in each food and how much food is in each serving.

Narrator:

Next, let's take a look at step two, here, we'll focus on the **calories**.

Calories provide our body with energy, and here, the calories listed on the nutrition label refer to how many calories are in **one serving**—not the whole package!

- For example, let's look at our nacho chips again.
- Here, we see that one serving of nacho chips, or 12 chips, equals **150 calories**.
- Compare that to a package of tortilla chips, where one serving, or 14 chips, is **130 calories**. More chips, but fewer calories!

But remember—low in calories doesn't **always** mean healthy.

For instance, zero-calorie sodas often contain artificial sweeteners, which research shows may increase the risk of heart disease, diabetes, and even mental health issues. So, it's not just about calories—it's also about what's inside.

Narrator:

Now, for step 3, we'll focus on the **nutrients you should limit**, these include:

- **Fat**
- **Cholesterol**
- **And Sodium**

It's important to understand how much fat, cholesterol, and sodium a food item has because overeating of these can harm your health.

Let's see what this looks like when we compare our nacho chips to our tortilla chips:

- Our nacho chips have **8 grams of fat, 0 milligrams of cholesterol, and 210 milligrams of sodium**
- However, tortilla chips have **7 grams of fat, 0 milligrams of cholesterol, and 90 milligrams of sodium. The choice is clear:** Tortilla chips are the healthier option!

Narrator:

Almost done! Let's move on to step 4. Look for nutrients you want to eat more of, such as:

- **Dietary fiber**
- **Protein**
- **Calcium**
- **And Iron**

These nutrients help keep you strong and healthy. Let's go back to our chip example.

- Nacho chips have **1 gram of fiber, 2 grams of protein, and 40 milligrams of calcium**
- On the other hand, tortilla chips have **3 grams of fiber, 2 grams of protein, and 50 milligrams of calcium**

Once again, tortilla chips come out on top!

Narrator:

Finally, for step 5, check for **added sugars**. These sugars aren't naturally in food—they're added during manufacturing. Common food items that include added sugars are:

- Sodas, candies, cereals, and cookies.

The recommendations states that we should try to keep added sugars to less than **10% of your daily calories**.

Narrator:

So how do we figure out how many calories that would mean?

Let's walk through an example together.

If our goal was to consume only 2,000-calories a day, 10% of 2,000 is 200, so our goal would be to limit Our intake of added sugar to 200 calories a day.

You might be wondering—if the label only tells us the *grams* of added sugar, how can we figure out how many *calories* that means?

It's actually simple: just multiply the grams of added sugar by **4**. That's because every gram of sugar contains about **4 calories**. So, if something has **50 grams** of added sugar, that's about **200 calories**—your entire daily limit if you're following a 2,000-calorie diet.

Now let's review some common unhealthy and healthy examples of foods with added sugars

Narrator:

Some common foods that have higher levels of added sugar include

- A single can of Pepsi, which is also a single serving, has around **41 grams of added sugar and 150 calories per can**—that's almost a whole day's worth of sugar!
- And just 3 Oreos, which is equal to one serving, contains 14 grams of added sugar and 160 calories.

On the other end, let's review some healthier examples with lower amounts of added sugars...

- Some flavored Greek yogurts can contain 10 grams of added sugar.
- And remember fruits don't have any added sugars, so enjoy as many as you want!

Narrator:

Well done! That concludes our review of the food label. Great job!

You've learned the basics of reading food labels. Use this knowledge to examine the foods in your life and make healthier choices that align with your goals. Thanks for watching, and try to make small steps towards eating healthy every day!

"Fruits for Your Health"

- **Visuals:** *Bright and colorful fruits falling into a basket.*

Narration:

- Did you know that eating fruits regularly can play a significant role in improving our overall health?
- Today, we'll explore 3 fruit-filled topics:
 1. **Why** fruits are an essential part of our diet
 2. **How much** fruit we should eat and
 3. Simple ways to enjoy more of them every day!

Narration:

- First, let's go over why fruits are so important in our daily diet.
- Well, fruits are rich in nutrients like:
 - **Vitamins**
 - **Minerals**
 - **Fiber**
 - **And Antioxidants**

These nutrients can help our bodies in so many ways, including:

- Supporting our overall health
- Strengthening our immune system
- And helping our bodies recover and heal more effectively.

Narration:

Now, let's take a closer look at different types of fruit! For example...

- **Berries** contain powerful antioxidants, these antioxidants can:
 - Protect your cells from aging and diseases such as cancer⁵
 - Lower the risk of Type 2 diabetes^{1,2}
 - And improve blood flow, and lower blood pressure³
- And if you want to maximize your antioxidants, research has shown that blueberries contain one of the highest antioxidant levels compared to all other fruits!²

Narration:

Let's move on to **citrus** fruits!

- Citrus fruits are a rich source of vitamin C, which supports our immune system and helps maintain healthy skin, bones, blood vessels, and body tissue⁶.
- Vitamin C also helps fight inflammation, which may lessen conditions such as arthritis⁶.
 - Recent studies have even shown that eating more citrus fruits can reduce certain cancers⁴

- And fiber in fruits improves digestion and supports a healthy weight—an important factor in cancer recovery and prevention.

So, we've covered why fruits are beneficial, but how do you know the right amount to eat?

Narration:

- The American Cancer Society and the Dietary Guidelines for Americans recommend consuming one and a half to two and a half cup equivalents of fruit per day for most adults.
- But what exactly is a **cup-equivalent** of fruit? Let's break it down!

 *Split screen: A measuring cup on one side, different fruits on the other.*

- A **cup-equivalent** means the amount of fruit that gives you the same nutrients as **one full cup of fruit**. But since fruits come in different shapes and sizes, they don't all fit neatly into a measuring cup!

 *Cut to: A small apple and a large banana appear next to a cup.*

- For example, **one small apple** or **one large banana** both count as **one cup-equivalent**, even though they look different!
- And you can even get your fruit cup-equivalents in different ways, for example:
 - **1 cup of fresh, frozen, or canned fruit**
 - **1 cup of 100% fruit juice**
 - **Or just a ½ cup of dried fruit**, because it's smaller and more concentrated, are all equal 1-cup equivalent of fruit!
- Here are some everyday examples of **1 cup-equivalent of fruit**:
 - 🍌 **1 large banana**
 - 🍏 **1 small apple**
 - 🍇 **32 grapes**
 - 🍉 **1 cup diced melon**
 - 🍊 **1 large orange**
 - 🥭 **1 cup mango chunks**

 *Cut to: A split-screen of a glass of juice and a whole apple.*

- And remember—**whole fruits** are better than juice because they have more **fiber**, which helps keep you full!
- Fruits are easy to mix and match! Whether you love fresh, frozen, or dried fruit, just make sure to **get your cups of fruit each day!**

Narration:

Now that you know why fruits are so important and how much fruit to eat, what are some easy ways we can add fruit into our diet? Let's go over some easy tips and tricks:

1. **Start your day with fruit:** Add berries to oatmeal or a banana to your yogurt!
2. **Snack smart:** Keep apple slices or a handful of dried fruits handy for a quick energy boost.
3. **Mix it up:** Create colorful fruit salads or fun smoothies like strawberry-banana or blueberry-pineapple!

4. **Get creative with desserts:** Enjoy frozen grapes, baked apples, or a fruit parfait for a sweet treat.

- Think of fruits as nature's candy—sweet, delicious, and packed with nutrients!

Narration:

And if you're worried about cost or convenience, don't worry! Here are some suggestions that may help.

- Buy seasonal fruits—they're often cheaper, fresher, and taste better too!
- Frozen fruits are just as nutritious as fresh fruits; they're often cheaper and they last longer! They're also perfect for your morning smoothie.
- Try to experiment with different fruits to find what you love.

Narration:

By making fruits a part of your daily routine, you're taking another step towards nourishing and protecting your body. Remember, every small choice adds up!

References

1. [Fruit consumption and risk of type 2 diabetes: results from three prospective longitudinal cohort studies - PMC](#)
2. [Acute Consumption of Blueberries and Short-Term Blueberry Supplementation Improve Glucose Management and Insulin Levels in Sedentary Subjects - PubMed](#)
3. [Effect of blueberry intervention on endothelial function: a systematic review and meta-analysis - PubMed](#)
4. [History, Global Distribution, and Nutritional Importance of Citrus Fruits - Liu - 2012 - Comprehensive Reviews in Food Science and Food Safety - Wiley Online Library](#)
5. [Are antioxidants helpful for disease prevention? - PMC](#)
6. [The Powerful Health Benefits of Citrus Fruits | The Whole U](#)

Animation #12 – From Plate to Store: A Supermarket Cheat Sheet

Animation link: <https://vimeo.com/1038306105/3b2176129e?share=copy>

Welcome to our guide on navigating the grocery store to build a healthy plate. With so many options available, it can be overwhelming to make nutritious choices. But fear not! By following these five simple steps, you'll be on your way to crafting a balanced and delicious meal."

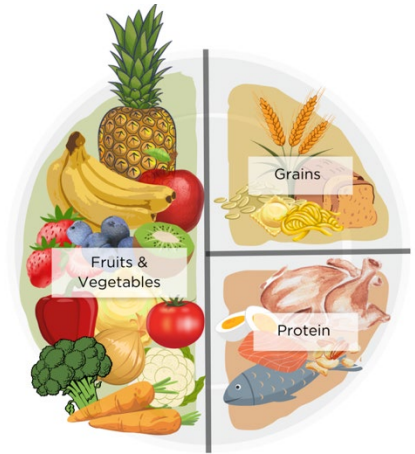
[Smart Grocery Shopping on a Budget | HPRC \(hprc-online.org\)](#)

- Let's discuss some tips and tricks in navigating the grocery store that will make building a healthy plate at home easier.

Step 1: Planning Ahead (NARRATOR STANDS IN FRONT OF A WHITEBOARD WITH A GROCERY LIST)

Narrator: "Before you even step foot into the store, take some time to plan your meals for the week. Create a grocery list based on these meals, ensuring you include a variety of fruits, vegetables, lean proteins, whole grains, and healthy fats."

Now, let's head to the grocery store!



Step 2: Start in the produce section (NARRATOR WALKS THROUGH THE PRODUCE SECTION, EXAMINING VARIOUS FRUITS AND VEGETABLES)

Narrator: "Once inside the store, head straight to the produce section. Here, you'll find a rainbow of fresh fruits and vegetables packed with essential vitamins, minerals, and antioxidants. Remember, the goal is to fill half of your plate with fruits and vegetables. If you're short on time when making your meals, don't be afraid to grab the pre-chopped veggies to make your life easier"

Step 3: Navigate the Perimeter to Find Your Proteins

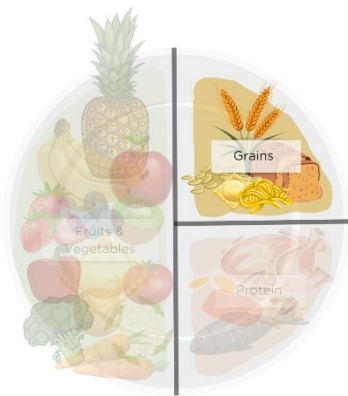
Narrator: "Next, make your way around the perimeter of the store. Here, you'll find excellent sources of protein and essential nutrients, perfect for building a healthy plate. Remember, the aim is to fill a quarter of your plate with leaner meats and avoid and limit highly processed and red meats. Lean meats include chicken or turkey, fish like salmon, cod, shrimp, and other proteins like eggs, and plant-based options like Tofu, which may also be found in the produce section."

Step 4: Don't forget about the Frozen Aisle

Narrator: "If you're afraid that your food may go bad or are short on time, don't overlook the frozen aisle. Here, you'll find a variety of frozen fruits, vegetables, chicken, and seafood, which are often just as nutritious as their fresh counterparts. Stock up on these convenient options to have healthy ingredients on hand for quick and easy meals."

Step 5: Explore the Aisles Mindfully

The inner aisles are typically the largest section. They have a lot of pre-packaged ultra-processed foods like chips, candy, and desserts (aka less nutritious foods) - enticing but ultimately not that great for you.



So first, head to find the grains. Remember, our goal is to fill the last quarter of our plate with grains, with at least half of that portion consisting of whole grains. In the dried goods area and the cereal aisle, there are many options for getting whole grains in. Look for whole-grain pasta, tortillas, oatmeal, brown rice, quinoa, and cereals. These whole grains will pack in more nutrients than regular refined grains like white rice.

Also in the inner aisles are the canned goods. The canned goods section also has many cheaper options for fruits and veggies—just keep an eye on added sugars! Beans and legumes, which can be found in the canned section, are good sources of protein.

The grocery store can be overwhelming, especially when trying to build healthier habits like this plate. Focus on these three food groups first and what you can add from them, which will help lower the amount of pre-packaged ultra-processed foods you grab in those tricky inner aisles.

Congratulations! You've conquered the grocery store and now have the tools to venture in like a pro! See you next time!

Resistance Training Benefits and Recommendations

Narrator:

Welcome! Today, we'll explore:

- The amazing benefits of strength training, and how much you should be doing!

So, what is strength training? Strength training, also called resistance training, involves a physical activity that strengthens muscles by exercising them against an outside force or weight, such as body weight, dumbbells, resistance bands, or machines¹.

So, what are some benefits of strength training, and why does it matter? You probably know that strength training builds muscle and endurance. But did you know that it also:

- Boosts brainpower and self-confidence,
- Improves heart health and lowers blood pressure, and
- Helps manage conditions like back pain, arthritis, type 2 diabetes, and cancer-related fatigue

It's also powerful for healthy aging, enhancing bone density, muscle health, and everyday function.

Narrator:

So, who should be strength training? Strength training is for everyone! It's safe and effective whether you're just starting out or staying active as you age.

Alright, so how much strength training should you do? Let's break down what the Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans and the American College of Sports Medicine recommend using the FITT principles: which stands for Frequency, Intensity, Time, and Type.

First, **Frequency, or how often we do an activity**

- The guidelines recommend engaging in muscle-strengthening activities at least **2 days per week** targeting **all seven major muscle groups** (legs, hips, back, chest, abdomen, shoulders, and arms).

Second, **Intensity**

- With strength training, you should aim for a **moderate or higher intensity**.
 - This means choosing a resistance level that makes the last few repetitions of your set feel **challenging to complete, but still able to complete safely and with good form**.
- A helpful way to gauge this is using a 0–10 RPE or rating of perceived exertion scale, where zero is no effort at all and ten means maximum effort.
- So for strength training, we aim for a **5 or 6**—it should feel like you're breathing heavier, your muscles are working, but you can still talk.

Third, **Time**

- Unlike aerobic exercise, **time in minutes isn't how we measure strength training.**
- Instead, we focus on **sets and repetitions.**
- The American College of Sports Medicine recommends doing **2 to 3 sets of 8 to 12 repetitions** for each major muscle group, resting between sets as needed.

Lastly, **Type**

- Include exercises using weights, resistance bands, or bodyweight exercises.
- It's up to you; just remember to target all muscle groups.

Narrator:

Strength training is one of the best investments you can make in your health—building strength, boosting confidence, and supporting long-term well-being.

Whether lifting weights, using resistance bands, or working with your body weight, the key is consistency. Remember, just two days a week can make a big difference! So, find movements you enjoy, challenge yourself, and keep getting stronger—your body will thank you!

Resistance Training Tip

Narrate: *Want to get stronger but not sure where to start? Here are four simple steps to begin resistance training safely and effectively.*

SHOW DON'T SAY:

Warm-Up to Prepare Your Body

Plan a Balanced Workout

Take Breaks and Recover

Build Up Over Time

Say: Step 1: Warm-Up to Prepare Your Body

- A proper warm-up helps prevent injury and allows you to lift with better form. *Start with 5–10 minutes of light movement.*

Get your blood flowing by starting with an easy aerobic warm-up – walk, cycle, or do gentle jumping jacks to get your heart rate up.

- ***Activate the muscles you'll train using dynamic moves that mimic your workout***, such as squats if you are targeting legs or arm circles if you are targeting the shoulders.

Step 2: Plan a Balanced Workout

Your plan should include frequency, muscle groups, reps/sets, and equipment."

(SHOW LIST OF THE FOUR POINTS BELOW)

- Let's start with frequency. Your goal is to achieve the recommendations [Show logos of the Physical Activity guidelines for Americans, the American Cancer Society, and the American College of Sports Medicine], which are to engage in muscle-strengthening activities on two or more days a week.
- Your plan should work all seven major muscle groups: legs, hips, back, chest, core, shoulders, and arms. Be sure to check out our instructional videos for additional exercises for each muscle group.
- Remember, the goal is to achieve the recommendations of 2 sets of 8-12 reps per muscle group. Again, "repetition" (or rep) is one complete movement of an exercise, and a "set" is a group of reps.
- Make sure you have what you need. Most times, bodyweight will be more than enough to improve your fitness. If not, you can always spice up your workout by using *resistance bands, dumbbells, or kettlebells, which can help add variety—just use them safely.*

Here's a PRO tip: if you want to keep Your Workouts Fun & Effective by switching things up....

- *Explore our survivor-created exercise videos that you can do anywhere—at home, at the park, or while traveling*
- We offer a range of bodyweight, dumbbell, and mind-body workouts like yoga, chair yoga, and Tai Chi.
- All of which can help you *build strength and improve health, so nothing gets in your way!*
-

Step 3: Take Breaks and Recover

Rest is essential for building strength safely.

- Take 1–3 minutes of rest between your sets to recover
- *Listen to your body. If you have health concerns or limitations, consult a healthcare professional to ensure safe activity levels.*

Step 4: Build Up Over Time

- *Progress gradually to stay safe and avoid injury. You can do this by either: Increasing the frequency or adding more reps per set, increase the duration by adding more sets or time, or by increasing the intensity, which can be done by adding heavier weights.*
- *Remember, this should be done gradually.*
- **Pro Tip:** For beginners and intermediates, *aim for an effort level of 6–7 out of 10 on the Rating of Perceived Exertion (RPE) by the end of your set.*

Well that covers the tips to start strength training safely and effectively.

By challenging your muscles regularly, they'll get stronger and more defined. 🙌

- *Strength training is a powerful way to boost your health—no matter your age, limitations, or experience level.”*

Start slow, stay consistent, and celebrate your progress!

Social Support

Narrator: Welcome back! In this video, we will talk about the importance of social support.

Social support means having people you can count on for help and support. Social support can come in many different forms, such as having someone to:

- Listen to you, give you advice, show you affection and celebrate your wins, someone to help you with building healthy habits, or even provide encouragement

Narrator: And social support can come from many different places. It could be someone who is watching this video with you, it could be a family member like your spouse, kids, or grandkids, close friends or neighbors, people from church or book clubs, or even a furry friend like a dog.

Narrator: Social support is important during times of low motivation or high stress! Science shows that people who report elevated levels of social support are happier, better able to cope with stress and healthier. As you may already know, managing a chronic illness such as cancer can be difficult at times, and social support can make it less stressful.

Narrator: Not all support is the same, and not all support is helpful in all situations. There are three types of social support that we're going to talk about today.

- The first is **emotional support**
- Followed by **informational support**
- And lastly, **tangible support**.

Narrator: Sources of **Emotional support** are people in your life to whom you can talk about how you feel. Doing so can feel encouraging, fun, or even comforting. For example, a survivor or caregiver could share concerns and fears with someone to reduce those feelings of helplessness.

Narrator: Sources of emotional support include people you can talk to about how you feel, such as your spouse, a close friend, a family member, a neighbor, or even a health coach.

Narrator: **Informational support** is about knowledge, this can look like getting help looking up information about medical decisions or someone to help you find new activities or foods that can lead to healthier lives.

Narrator: So, one example of informational support for your cancer care includes your medical team. For example, a dietitian could help identify foods that may reduce symptoms you're dealing with.

Narrator: Lastly, **tangible support** includes things like having someone to go for a walk, help you with household chores, or perhaps even cook new recipes. It's important to note, when choosing who falls into what group, remember not everyone falls into two or more groups.

Narrator: For example, your provider likely cannot **give you a ride to the store**, but they can provide you with informational support. On the other hand, it may be better to ask your provider about treatment options than your kids, who may not have any medical training.

Narrator: Great job! That concludes our video of the importance and each type of social support. As the famous American Author Helen Keller once said, "Alone we can do so little; together we can do so much."

Narrator: Now, get out there and start building meaningful social connections.

Mastering Mindful Eating

[Title Screen: "Mastering Mindful Eating"]

Narrator: Welcome back! Today, we're diving into the practice of *mindful eating*.

[Scene Transition: Illustration of Alice in her busy daily routine]

Narrator: Let's begin with an example. Meet Alice. She juggles a demanding job and a packed schedule. During lunch, she eats takeout while working, barely noticing her food. At dinner, she's glued to her phone, scrolling through notifications and social media. Later, while watching her favorite TV show, she grabs a bag of chips—not out of hunger, but habit. Before she knows it, the bag is empty, and she barely remembers eating it.

[Cut to relatable animation of various people eating distractedly]

Narrator: Sound familiar? Like Alice, many of us get swept up in the distractions of daily life, falling into the trap of *mindless eating*. But what if we could transform our relationship with food?

[Title Screen: "What is Mindful Eating?"]

Narrator: So let's talk about what mindful eating is! Mindful eating helps us focus on:

1. The WHY..and
2. The HOW we eat

Unlike typical diets that focus on *what*, *how much*, and *when* to eat, mindful eating centers on **awareness and intentions**.

[Scene Transition: Highlighting the "Why"]

Narrator: First, the **why** focuses on our motivations for eating.

- Are we eating to..Meet a goal, like consuming five servings of fruits and vegetables a day?
- Are we eating to..Improve our health, manage weight, or reduce the risk of diseases like heart disease or diabetes?
- Or are we eating to.. relieve symptoms that we may be experiencing like nausea, constipation, or diarrhea?

[Cut to Alice making thoughtful food choices]

Narrator: Mindful eating encourages us to make food choices that align with our personal goals or, in other words, our why.

[Scene Transition: Highlighting the "How"]

Narrator: Second, the **how** in mindful eating is all about how we eat our food. Mindful eating promotes slowing down and being present when eating. This is important because when we take our time, we allow our stomach to send signals to our brain that we're satisfied and full.

[Illustration of chewing and digestion]

Narrator: Chewing thoroughly kickstarts digestion, enhances nutrient absorption, and makes eating more enjoyable. So, next time you eat, remember to *slowwww it dowwwwnnn!*

[Title Screen: "Benefits of Mindful Eating"]

Narrator: Let's discuss some of the many benefits of mindful eating. Unlike the distractions and multitasking we saw with Alice, mindful eating helps us tune into the experience, reconnecting us with the joy and purpose of eating. Other benefits include:

[List appears on-screen, accompanied by illustrations]

- Preventing overeating.
 - Supporting better digestion.
 - Helping maintain a healthy weight.
 - Improving metabolic health, including blood sugar, cholesterol, and blood pressure. And
 - Enhancing our appreciation of food.
-

[Title Screen: "Tips for Mindful Eating"]

Narrator: So if you're ready to give mindful eating a try, here are some easy tips to get started:

[Illustration: Person putting away a phone]

Tip #1: *Eliminate distractions.* Put away your devices, stop multitasking, and focus solely on your food when eating.

[Illustration: Person pausing before eating, noticing the food]

Tip #2: *Pause before eating.* Take a moment to notice the colors, textures, smells, and flavors of your food. Ask yourself: *Does this align with my goals? Will it make me feel my best?*

[Illustration: Person eating slowly and chewing thoroughly]

Tip #3: *Slow down.* Chew thoroughly, take breaks between bites, and listen to your body's signals of satisfaction and fullness.

Tip #4: Lastly, start small and simple. Practicing mindful eating in our busy lives can seem challenging, but don't worry—perfection isn't the goal. Start small with one mindful meal or snack each day.

[Closing Scene: Illustration of Alice eating mindfully, smiling]

Narrator: You've got this! Apply a tip or two, and you'll be on your way to mastering mindful eating. Here's to enjoying your meals and nourishing your body with intention.

Animation #25 – Nutrition Unmasked: Debunking Common Food Myths

- Purpose: Address and debunk common misconceptions surrounding nutrition and food so that viewers can better sift through information to distinguish fact from false statements.

Narrator: Nutrition is a **crucial** part of our health and daily life, but navigating the world of food myths can be overwhelming. Today, we're here to debunk some of the most common myths. **Let's dive in!**

Narrator: *Myth #1: Carbs are the enemy!*

Carbohydrates are **actually an essential nutrient** and our body's preferred source of energy **to keep us fueled and ready for the day**. But not all carbs are created equal! Carbohydrates from fruits, vegetables, whole grains, and beans come with fiber, vitamins, and minerals that are **great for our health**. **Try to prioritize these** over sugary and refined foods like cookies, cakes, and chips, which lack nutrients and **won't make your body feel its best**.

Narrator: *Myth #2: Fat makes you gain weight and is bad for you!*

Not true! Weight gain is influenced by many factors, but it **generally comes down** to consuming more calories than **your body needs**. While fats are more calorie-dense than carbs or proteins, **they're not bad for you unless overconsumed**. In fact, fats are an essential part of a balanced diet. **Focus on healthy fats**—like monounsaturated and polyunsaturated fats, found in foods such as avocados, nuts, olive oil, and oily fish. These fats **promote heart health, reduce inflammation, and support brain function**. On the other hand, it's **wise to limit saturated fats**, typically found in butter and cheese.

Note for animator: Use a split screen to **visually distinguish healthy fats (in green) from unhealthy fats (in red)**. **Link the benefits to the healthy fats** so viewers make the right association.

Narrator: *Myth #3: Fruit is bad because it's full of sugar!*

Yes, fruit contains natural sugar (**fructose**), but it also comes packed with nutrients like vitamin C, calcium, potassium, and fiber, **which aid in digestion and sugar absorption**. Fruits offer **a lot more nutritional value than processed foods** like cookies or candy, which lack these essential nutrients.

Narrator: *Myth #4: You should avoid all processed foods.*

Think of processed foods on a spectrum. At one end, there are **ultra-processed foods** like cookies, ice cream, chips, and hot dogs. These foods are packed with fats, sugars, salts, and additives and **offer little nutritional benefit, so it's best to limit them**. On the other end, minimally processed foods like quinoa, brown rice, canned beans, nut butters, and pre-cut veggies are **closer to their natural state and rich in nutrients, making them a great choice for a balanced diet**.

Narrator: *Myth #5: Fresh fruits and vegetables are always better than frozen.*

Both fresh and frozen fruits and vegetables are nutritious, so **choose what works best for you!** While fresh produce can be fantastic, it **may lose nutrients if left out too long**. Frozen fruits and vegetables, however, are often picked and preserved **at peak freshness**, locking in their nutrients. **Canned goods can also retain nutrients due to quick processing, and they're often more budget-friendly**.

Narrator: While debunking these myths **can help clear up confusion**, it's always a good idea to consult with a registered dietitian or nutrition professional to **ensure your eating habits align with your health goals**. Remember, understanding the truth about nutrition **can empower you** to make informed decisions about your health and the foods **you enjoy**.

Narrator: Nutrition is an important part of our health and daily life but navigating the wild world of food myths can feel overwhelming. Today we will be debunking several common myths so let's get into it!

Narrator: Myth #1: Carbs are the enemy!

Carbohydrates are an essential nutrient and our body's preferred energy source for keeping us fueled and ready to tackle the day! But not all carbs are created equally, folks! Sources like fruits, vegetables, whole grains, and beans are packed with the good stuff – like fiber, vitamins and minerals -which are great for our health! Make sure to prioritize these over sugary and refined foods like cookies, cakes, and chips that lack those nutrients and will not make your body feel its best!

Narrator: Myth #2: Fat makes you obese and is bad for you!

This is simply not true! Weight gain is influenced by many factors, but it can boil to consuming more calories than what your body needs. Did you know that fats pack more calories per gram than carbs or proteins? And they aren't bad for you unless overconsumed, in fact they are an essential part of a balanced diet. It's all about choosing the right fats which are monounsaturated and polyunsaturated fats found in foods such as yummy avocados, nuts, olive oil, and oily fish. On the other hand, we want to limit or avoid fats like saturated fats which are typically found in butter and cheese. And why should we eat the good fats? Well because they promote heart health, reduce inflammation, and support brain function!

*Note for animator: To explain benefits of good fats, we can make it more visual to distinguish them from the bad fats. Link benefits to good fats so viewers are not confused and associate them with the bad fats. Split screen of green healthy fats, and red with unhealthy.

Narrator: Myth #3: Fruit is bad because it is full of sugar!

Yes, while fruit has sugar, also called fructose, it also comes packed with nutrients, such as vitamin C, minerals like calcium and potassium, and of course, fiber – which is great for digestion and sugar absorption and much better for our bodies than processed foods like cookies and candy which lack the nutrients that fruits bring to the table.

Narrator: Myth #4: You should avoid all processed foods.

When it comes to processed foods, think of them on a spectrum. At one extreme, you've got the heavy hitters like cookies, ice cream, chips, candy, sausage and hot dogs. These guys have been through the ringer with loads of fats, sugars, salts, and additives added in and are known as ultra-processed foods. They are not the healthiest choices because they can lack essential nutrients, so aim to limit or avoid entirely. On the other end of the spectrum, are more minimally processed foods such as quinoa, brown rice, lettuce, canned beans, nut butters, and pre-cut vegetables. These are closer to their natural state and are packed with nutrients that will make your body feel better and healthier – so stick to these!

Narrator: Myth #5: Fresh fruits and vegetables are always better than frozen!

All forms of fruits and veggies can be nutritious so choose what works best for you! Fresh fruits and veggies can be great, but lose nutrients over time if left sitting out. If that's the case, then aim for frozen fruits and veggies, which are preserved at peak freshness, locking in nutrients. Because of the quick processing with canned goods, nutrients are also retained and often are cheaper than fresh options.

Narrator: Myth #6: You shouldn't eat past 7 pm!

Thankfully, your digestive system does not clock out at bedtime, so eating later at night is no issue, but make sure to be mindful of your hunger and the foods you choose to eat. If you find yourself snacking during a late-night Netflix binge or while winding down after a long day, you might be reaching for those less nutritious, more sugary, salty, or higher calories foods. So focus on eating mindfully if you do choose to eat later.

Narrator: While debunking these myths helps to clear the air of misinformation, remember to always meet with your registered dietitian or nutrition professional to help make sure **you** are eating in a way that is aligned you're your health goals! And remember, knowing the truth about nutrition, especially after we have debunked these common myths, can help you make more informed decisions about your health and the foods you choose to eat.

Research Links:

<https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/weight-management/myths-nutrition-physical-activity>

<https://programs.online.american.edu/msne/masters-nutrition-education/resources/food-and-nutrition-myths>

<https://newsnetwork.mayoclinic.org/discussion/mayo-clinic-q-and-a-10-nutrition-myths-debunked/>

<https://www.choc.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/02/Nutrition-mythbusters-Final-7.2022-PDF-.pdf>

[What Are Ultra-Processed Foods? \(clevelandclinic.org\)](#)

The Power of Vegetables

Narrator:

Today we'll talk about one of the simplest ways to improve your health and even lower your cancer risk, and it's probably already in your kitchen! That's right – we're talking about vegetables. Vegetables are nature's superfoods, packed with nutrients and benefits to support your body and overall well-being.

Today, we're going to dive into 3 topics:

1. **Why** vegetables are vegetables so important
2. The **amount** of vegetables you should be eating and
3. Some easy ways to enjoy them every day

Let's get started!

Narrator: First, let's explore why vegetables are so beneficial for your health. Did you know that vegetables are packed with essential nutrients that help your body function at its best? Let's take a closer look at what makes them so special:

They're loaded with vitamins and minerals that support your health in many ways.

For example:

- Vitamin C -found in bell peppers, broccoli, and spinach- helps boost your immune system and supports cell repair.
- Vitamin A - found in carrots, sweet potatoes, and kale- plays a key role in reducing inflammation and maintaining healthy vision.
- B vitamins, found in veggies like potatoes, leafy greens, black beans, and mushrooms, support energy production, helping your body convert food into fuel.
- Potassium and magnesium—two key minerals found in vegetables like sweet potatoes, beans, and in spinach — help regulate blood pressure and support muscle function.

Vegetables are also rich in fiber, which promotes healthy digestion and reduces the risk of colorectal cancer .

Beyond vitamins and minerals, vegetables contain unique bioactive compounds, such as antioxidants and phytochemicals, which help reduce inflammation, protect cells from damage, and may even slow the growth of cancer cells.

By making vegetables a regular part of your diet, you're giving your body the nutrients it needs to thrive!

Vegetables are even a great partner for managing your weight. They're low in calories but loaded with nutrients, helping you feel full for longer periods of time². Adding more vegetables to your diet is essential for maintaining a healthy weight, which can help prevent obesity and reduce your risk of 13 different types of cancers.

Narrator: Now that we know **why** vegetables are an important addition to your daily diet, let's talk about **how much** you should be eating. **According to the American Cancer Society and Dietary Guidelines for Americans, adults should aim for at least two to four cup-equivalents of vegetables every day.**

Let's break down what that means:

- One cup-equivalent could be:
 - 1 cup of raw or cooked vegetables,
 - or 2 cups of leafy greens,
 - or a half cup of dried vegetables.

This is because not all vegetables have the same volume, density, or concentration! Let's go over some specific examples to help us.

- A cup-equivalent could also be one large bell-pepper, one large cucumber, around eight cauliflower florets, two cups of leafy greens, or a cup of 100% vegetable juice!

It's important to note that variety **matters**! Focus on eating dark leafy greens, as well as colorful vegetables. Each type of vegetable brings its own set of nutrients and health benefits, so it's important to get as many of each as possible!

Narrator:

Alright, you might be thinking, 'This sounds great, but how do I actually eat **that** many vegetables every day?'. Don't worry, we've got you covered with some easy tips and tricks:

1. **Start Small:** Begin by adding one extra vegetable to a meal you're already eating. For example, toss some spinach into your morning eggs or add extra broccoli to your dinner plate.
2. **Meal Prep:** Wash, chop, and store your vegetables ahead of time. This makes them easy to grab and use throughout the week.
3. **Sneak Them In:** Blend greens like kale or spinach into smoothies, mix grated zucchini into pasta sauce, layer veggies in your sandwiches, or add extra vegetables to your soups and stews! Chicken noodle soup tastes even better with extra carrots, celery and onions.

And if you're on the go, keep it simple! Carry snackable veggies like baby carrots or cucumber slices for a healthy bite wherever you are.

Narrator:

Vegetables are your secret weapon for better health. They're nutrient dense, help manage weight, and can reduce your risk of cancer. Start small, get creative, and make them a delicious part of your daily life. Remember, every small step, *or bite*, counts!

References

1. [Foods to deliver immune-supporting nutrients - ScienceDirect](#)
2. [American Cancer Society guideline for diet and physical activity for cancer prevention - Rock - 2020 - CA: A Cancer Journal for Clinicians - Wiley Online Library](#)
3. [Dietary polyphenols, oxidative stress and antioxidant and anti-inflammatory effects - ScienceDirect](#)
4. [Potential Health Benefits of Plant Food-Derived Bioactive Components: An Overview - PMC](#)
5. [Fruits and Vegetables Serving Sizes Infographic | American Heart Association](#)
6. [Vitamin A as an anti-inflammatory agent | Proceedings of the Nutrition Society | Cambridge Core](#)
7. [Vitamins and Minerals for Energy, Fatigue and Cognition: A Narrative Review of the Biochemical and Clinical Evidence - PMC](#)
8. [Key minerals to help control blood pressure - Harvard Health](#)

Animation: Flexibility and Stretching

7.14.25

Animation Script: Improve Your Flexibility with Stretching

(Scene: Upbeat, animated intro with diverse characters of different ages and abilities—some doing yoga, stretching, and Tai Chi. Title card appears: “Improve Your Flexibility with Stretching”)

Narrator (Warm, friendly voice): Welcome! In today’s video, we’re going to explore the benefits of stretching and why it matters—especially if you’re a cancer survivor.

(Scene: A character bends to tie their shoe, another reaches for a cabinet, another turns their head to check traffic. The words “Stretching,” “Flexibility,” and “Mobility” appear.)

Narrator: Stretching exercises help improve your flexibility, or the range of motion **of** joints.

That’s what allows you to reach, bend, and twist comfortably in your daily life [IJSPT, 2012; U.S. PAG, 2018].

Benefits of stretching include:

- Reduced stiffness and muscle tension
 - Easier, more comfortable movement
 - Improved posture
 - Better joint health
 - Faster recovery after exercise
 - And potentially fewer injuries [IJSPT, 2012].
-

(Scene: A character stands taller after stretching. Another character touches their toes with more ease.)

Narrator: Over time, consistent stretching helps lengthen tight muscles and improve your body’s ability to tolerate the sensation of stretching. This makes daily activities like tying your shoes or getting out of a chair a little easier [IJSPT, 2012].

(Scene: A friendly group of cancer survivors smiling in a gentle yoga class. One has a visible post-surgery scar. Another is recovering from chemotherapy.)

Narrator: For people who’ve been treated for cancer, stretching can be especially beneficial.

Treatments like surgery, radiation, and chemotherapy can cause:

- *Muscle tightness*
- *Nerve pain*
- *Stiffness*
- *Or reduced range of motion [Campbell et al., 2019; PAG, 2018]*

Stretching helps relieve some of that discomfort and improves your ability to move with confidence.

(Scene: Visual of an older adult walking steadily; balance, strength, and flexibility appear as a 3-part foundation beneath them.)

Narrator: *It also plays a role in fall prevention.*

Stretching supports balance and mobility, two key components in reducing fall risk, which is especially important for older adults and cancer survivors [PAG, 2018]. Did you know that falls are the leading cause of injury for adults ages 65 and older, with 1 in 4 older adults experiencing a fall each year?

(Scene: Characters enjoying multicomponent activities—yoga, Tai Chi, dancing—with visual icons for balance, strength, and aerobic fitness.)

Narrator: *Many enjoyable activities—like yoga, Tai Chi, or dancing—combine stretching with balance, strength, and aerobic fitness. These are called multicomponent activities, and they’re especially helpful for improving physical function and independence [PAG, 2018].*

(Scene: Animated figure with major muscle groups highlighted—neck, shoulders, back, hips, legs.)

Narrator: *So when you stretch, try to focus on the major muscle groups of the body:*

- *Neck*
 - *Shoulders*
 - *Chest*
 - *Back*
 - *Abdomen*
 - *Hips and glutes*
 - *And Legs [IJSPT, 2012]*
-

(Scene: Character demonstrates a seated hamstring stretch with a clock counting 10 to 30 seconds.)

Narrator: Each stretch should be held for 10 to 30 seconds, and you can go up to 60 seconds if a muscle feels particularly tight.

Aim to stretch at least 2 to 3 days a week [IJSPT, 2012; ACSM, 2019].

(Scene: After a walk, a character gently stretches with a checklist onscreen.)

Narrator:

Here are a few tips for safe stretching:

- First, No bouncing—hold each position steadily
 - Stop if it hurts—you should feel tension or a slight discomfort, but not pain
 - And remember—stretching is great for flexibility **but does not replace the aerobic or muscle-strengthening recommendations; —each plays a distinct role in supporting your health.**⁴³[PAG, 2018]
-

(Scene: Final montage of characters enjoying life—walking the dog, gardening, dancing, playing with grandchildren.)

Narrator: Stretching is a small habit that offers big rewards.

It helps you move better, feel better, and live with greater ease and independence.

Talk to your doctor or a certified fitness professional to create a stretching routine that works for you!

Inline References

- **IJSPT = Page et al., 2012, Current Concepts in Muscle Stretching (file: “current concepts...pdf”)**
- **PAG = U.S. Physical Activity Guidelines, 2nd Edition (file: “Physical_Activity_Guidelines_2nd_edition”)**
- **ACSM = Campbell et al., 2019, Exercise Guidelines for Cancer Survivors (file: “campbell 2019 2.pdf”)**

Stretching: Focusing on Flexibility Script

AI Prompt: I'm making a script for an animation that will be part of a digital physical activity and healthy eating intervention. I'm making a script about the importance and tips of stretching. I want to base this on recommendations, primarily the 2018 physical activity guidelines for Americans, then the American College of Sports Medicine, especially the Moving Through Cancer principles:

<https://acsm.org/education-resources/trending-topics-resources/cancer/> , and the American Cancer Society physical activity guidelines for cancer survivors and cancer prevention, and lastly, the American Institute of Cancer Research physical activity guidelines. Also I would like to define what stretching is, provide value by showing the benefits and how those can translate into their lives, and then give the instructions of like what to stretch (7 body regions), how long, when, and some tips like incorporating into the workouts not to have separate sessions if that helps. Please also provide references and be clear about where the recommendations come from, like:

- Well, the **American College of Sports Medicine (ACSM)** recommends stretching **at least 2 to 3 times per week**, focusing on major muscle groups to maintain flexibility and mobility [1,3].
- And according to **ACSM guidelines** and evidence from flexibility research, each stretch should be **held for 10 to 30 seconds**, and can be extended to **up to 60 seconds** if the muscles are especially tight or if you're aiming to increase flexibility over time [1,4].

1. American College of Sports Medicine, Riebe, D., Ehrman, J. K., Liguori, G., & Magal, M. (Eds.). (2018). *ACSM's guidelines for exercise testing and prescription* (Tenth edition). (pp. 167-169; 309). Wolters Kluwer.
2. Davies SC, Atherton F, McBride M and Calderwood C. UK chief medical officers' physical activity guidelines. UK Government, 2019. Available from: https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/832868/uk-chief-medical-officers-physical-activity-guidelines.pdf
3. Garber CE, Blissmer B, Deschenes MR, et al. American College of Sports Medicine position stand. The quantity and quality of exercise for developing and maintaining cardiorespiratory, musculoskeletal, and neuromotor fitness in apparently healthy adults: guidance for prescribing exercise. *Med Sci Sports Exerc.* 2011;43(7):1334-59.
4. Ingram, L. A., Tomkinson, G. R., d'Unienville, N. M. A., Gower, B., Gleadhill, S., Boyle, T., & Bennett, H. (2024). Optimising the Dose of Static Stretching to Improve Flexibility: A Systematic Review, Meta-analysis and Multivariate Meta-regression. *Sports medicine (Auckland, N.Z.)*, 10.1007/s40279-024-02143-9. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40279-024-02143-9>

Also, here is a good example of how they broke this down in a blog: <https://www.mayoclinic.org/healthy-lifestyle/fitness/in-depth/stretching/art-20047931>

Let's make sure not to plagiarize.

In today's video, we're going to discuss the importance of the basics of stretching.

We know exercise is essential, but what about stretching?

Animation Script: Improve Your Flexibility with Stretching

(Scene: Upbeat, animated intro with diverse characters of different ages and abilities, including some doing yoga poses and Tai Chi movements. Title card appears: "Improve Your Flexibility with Stretching")

Narrator (Warm, friendly voice): Welcome! ¹In today's video, we're going to discuss the importance and basics of stretching. ²The information we'll share is based on recommendations from leading health organizations like the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services and the American College of Sports Medicine. ³Whether you're looking to support your fitness routine or simply move more easily through your day, this is for you. ⁴

(Scene: An animated character bends down to tie their shoe with ease. The words "Flexibility" and "Range of Motion" appear on screen.)

Narrator: So, what exactly is stretching? ⁵Stretching exercises are physical activities that are designed to improve your **flexibility**. ⁶Flexibility is the range of motion you have available at your joints, like your hips or shoulders. ⁷Think of it as what allows you to reach, bend, and twist comfortably in your daily life. ⁸ Think about some of the daily movements we may take for granted, like:

- Reaching for a high shelf
 - Bending to tie your shoes
 - Turning your head to check traffic
 - Or even playing with your grandkids
-

(Scene: An older adult is shown walking confidently, avoiding a stumble. Another character with a surgical scar on their shoulder is shown reaching up to a shelf without wincing.)

Narrator: Why is this so important?

⁹One of the biggest reasons is fall prevention. ¹⁰Factors like age, a cancer diagnosis, and other health conditions can all increase the risk of a fall. ¹¹Studies show that people with cancer can be at a higher risk of falling. ¹²This is because cancer and its treatments can cause side effects such as muscle weakness, fatigue, and nerve problems that affect balance. ¹³Some treatments can also lead to bone loss, which makes falls more serious when they happen. ¹⁴

(Scene: An animation shows the concepts of "Strength," "Balance," and "Flexibility" as three pillars supporting a person.)

Narrator: The good news is that you can take action. ¹⁵Physical activity programs that include balance training, muscle strengthening, and aerobic activity can help reduce your risk of falls and injuries. ¹⁶These activities work together to improve your physical function, which is your ability to handle everyday tasks. ¹⁷For cancer

survivors, stretching can also be very helpful in addressing stiffness that may result from treatments like surgery. ¹⁸

(Scene: Animated characters are shown participating in a yoga class, a chair yoga class, and a Tai Chi group in a park.)

Narrator: You don't have to do these activities separately. ¹⁹Many recreational activities like yoga, Tai Chi, and dancing are great because they are "multicomponent." ²⁰This means they combine stretching and flexibility with balance, muscle strengthening, and aerobic activity all at once. ²¹Because of their gentler nature, activities like Tai Chi and many forms of yoga are great, low-impact ways to improve your physical function. ²²

(Scene: A clear, graphical breakdown appears on screen showing a human figure with major muscle groups highlighted.)

Narrator: When you do decide to stretch, the goal is to target the major muscle groups of your body. ²³Let's focus on seven key areas. ²⁴

(As each is mentioned, it's highlighted on the animated figure)

1. Your Neck ²⁵
2. Shoulders ²⁶
3. Chest ²⁷
4. Back ²⁸
5. Abdomen ²⁹
6. Your Hips and Glutes ³⁰
7. And your Legs. ³¹

(Scene: An animated character demonstrates a simple hamstring stretch. A timer appears on screen counting from 10 to 30 seconds.)

Narrator: Each stretch should be held for 10 to 30 seconds to the point of feeling tightness or a slight pull. ³²You can hold it for up to 60 seconds if a muscle feels particularly tight. ³³You should aim to do these flexibility exercises at least 2 to 3 days per week. ³⁴

(Scene: An animated character is shown finishing a brisk walk and then doing a few stretches.)

Narrator: Remember these key tips for a safe and effective routine. ³⁵

- **Warm up first.** ³⁶Never stretch a cold muscle. ³⁷
- **Don't bounce.** ³⁸Hold your stretches in a steady position. ³⁹
- **It shouldn't hurt.** ⁴⁰Stretching should not cause pain. ⁴¹
- **Keep Your Goals in Mind.** ⁴² **It's important to know that while stretching is a key part of a healthy routine, this does not replace the aerobic or muscle-strengthening recommendations; they each add benefits to your health.** ⁴³

(Scene: A final montage shows all the diverse characters from the video moving freely and happily. Key takeaways appear on screen.)

Narrator: Whether you're doing dedicated stretches or joining a yoga class, improving your flexibility is a great investment in your health. ⁴⁴It can help you move better, feel better, and stay independent and active for life. ⁴⁵

(Ending slate with a call to action: "Talk to your doctor or a certified fitness professional to create a plan that's right for you!")

References

1. This is a transition or introductory sentence written for the script and is not from a provided source.
2. U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. (2018). *Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans* (2nd ed.).
3. American College of Sports Medicine, Riebe, D., Ehrman, J. K., Liguori, G., & Magal, M. (Eds.). (2018). *ACSM's guidelines for exercise testing and prescription* (Tenth edition).
4. U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. (2018). *Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans* (2nd ed.). (p. 61)
5. U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. (2018). *Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans* (2nd ed.). (p. 30, 105)

6. U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. (2018). *Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans* (2nd ed.). (p. 67)
7. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (2023). *Facts About Falls*. Retrieved from <https://www.cdc.gov/falls/facts.html>
8. Sattar, S., Haase, K., Kuster, S., Puts, M., Spoelstra, S., Bradley, C., Wildes, T. M., & Alibhai, S. (2021). Falls in older adults with cancer: an updated systematic review of prevalence, injurious falls, and impact on cancer treatment. *Supportive care in cancer : official journal of the Multinational Association of Supportive Care in Cancer*, 29(1), 21–33.
9. Campbell, K. L., Winters-Stone, K. M., Wiskemann, J., et al. (2019). Exercise guidelines for cancer survivors: consensus statement from international multidisciplinary roundtable. *Medicine & science in sports & exercise*, 51(11), 2375-2390.
10. U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. (2018). *Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans* (2nd ed.). (p. 38)
11. U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. (2018). *Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans* (2nd ed.). (p. 73)
12. U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. (2018). *Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans* (2nd ed.). (p. 70)
13. Campbell, K. L., Winters-Stone, K. M., Wiskemann, J., et al. (2019). Exercise guidelines for cancer survivors: consensus statement from international multidisciplinary roundtable. *Medicine & science in sports & exercise*, 51(11), 2375-2390. (p. 11)
14. U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. (2018). *Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans* (2nd ed.). (p. 91)
15. Campbell, K. L., Winters-Stone, K. M., Wiskemann, J., et al. (2019). *ACSM's Guidelines for Exercise Testing and Prescription* (10th ed.). (Table 5, p. 14)

Introduction:

Narrator:

Welcome to today's video on stretching and flexibility.

In this short video, we'll explore:

- **What** stretching is
- **Why** it matters
- **How** to properly stretch
- And **when** to stretch.

What & Why:

First, let's start with the basics.

Stretching is more than just being able to touch your toes or do the splits.

Stretching *improves your flexibility*—which helps your body move **more freely**. [2,8].

Think about some of the daily movements we may take for granted— like:

- Reaching for a high shelf
- Bending to tie your shoes
- Turning your head to check traffic
- Or even playing with your grandkids

Stretching our muscles may help make **all that** a little bit easier [2,4,8].

Stretching can also **relieve stiffness** in your muscles and joints, which can help your body feel more loose and relaxed [6].

And it can also **support better posture** and **improve your balance and stability**—which is important for lowering the risk of falls [1,3,8].

Falls are the leading cause of injury for adults ages 65 and older, with 1 in 4 experiencing a fall each year [11]. **And those with cancer or recovering from cancer are at an even higher risk [10].**

Treatments like **chemotherapy** and **hormone therapy** may cause side effects such as muscle weakness, fatigue, or nerve problems in the hands and feet. Some treatments can also lead to bone loss, which makes falls more serious when they happen [10].

Gentle movement and stretching can help improve balance and coordination, helping you feel steadier and more confident in your daily life.

What to Stretch:

Narrator:

So now we know **why** we should stretch, let's go over what areas of the body we can focus on.

Stretching different parts of the body helps support overall mobility. From your neck and shoulders, down to your legs and ankles—every area plays a role in how we move, sit, and feel each day.

You don't have to stretch everything at once. Just choose a few areas that feel tight, tense, or overworked.

For example:

- Feeling stiff in your legs? Try a gentle hamstring or quad stretch.
- Achy back? Reach up or gently bend side to side to loosen your spine.
- Tension in your hips or trunk? Try seated leg hugs or sit cross-legged to open things up.

And always listen to your body. If something feels tight, spend a little more time there [1,5]. A few stretches here and there can go a long way.

How to Stretch:

Narrator:

Now let's talk about **how** to stretch.

Life can get busy, and it may feel like there's no time. But here's the good news: **stretching only takes a few minutes, and you can do it almost anywhere.**

You don't need fancy equipment—just a little space and a few minutes of focus. But before we dive in and go through some simple steps, it's important to note—**stretching should never be painful** [6]. You want to feel a gentle pull and which can cause discomfort. But if it hurts, **ease up**.

And **remember**—you can stretch at **any time of day**.

- **Morning stretches** help shake off stiffness and wake up your body.
- And **evening stretches** are a calming way to wind down and relax before bed.

When and How Often:

Narrator:

So, you might be wondering—when is the best time to stretch?

Stretching is great before and after you work your muscles—like when you exercise—to help warm up and cool down.

This helps:

- Prevent muscle strain
- Promote recovery
- And lower the risk of injury [3,5,7].

But it's also helpful in everyday life.

Whether you're getting out of bed, loosening up after sitting for a long time, or winding down in the evening, a few simple stretches can help your body feel more relaxed and mobile.

So, whether you're prepping for physical activity or simply want to start or end your day feeling better, stretching is a smart move.

But **how often** should you stretch—and for **how long**?

- Well, the **American College of Sports Medicine (ACSM)** recommends stretching **at least 2 to 3 times per week**, focusing on major muscle groups to maintain flexibility and mobility [1,3].
- And according to **ACSM guidelines** and evidence from flexibility research, each stretch should be **held for 10 to 30 seconds**, and can be extended to **up to 60 seconds** if the muscles are especially tight or if you're aiming to increase flexibility over time [1,4].
- Other organizations like **Mayo Clinic** emphasize that stretching should feel like a gentle pull—not pain—and encourages longer holds for deeper tension relief [6].

You're in control here. Start with what feels manageable and build up gradually. The key is consistency and being kind to your body.

Closing:

Narrator:

Stretching is a simple, powerful way to care for your body.

It helps improve flexibility, ease tension, and support your daily movement—so you can feel better and move better.

Thanks for joining today and *remember*: just a few minutes of stretching can make a big difference in your movement!

“It is now emphasised that activities to improve strength, balance and flexibility can be incorporated into sessions that also involve MVPA, rather than necessarily being in addition.”[[LINK](#)]

References:

5. American College of Sports Medicine, Riebe, D., Ehrman, J. K., Liguori, G., & Magal, M. (Eds.). (2018). *ACSM's guidelines for exercise testing and prescription* (Tenth edition). (pp. 167-169; 309). Wolters Kluwer.
6. Davies SC, Atherton F, McBride M and Calderwood C. UK chief medical officers' physical activity guidelines. UK Government, 2019. Available from:
https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/832868/uk-chief-medical-officers-physical-activity-guidelines.pdf
7. Garber CE, Blissmer B, Deschenes MR, et al. American College of Sports Medicine position stand. The quantity and quality of exercise for developing and maintaining cardiorespiratory, musculoskeletal, and neuromotor fitness in apparently healthy adults: guidance for prescribing exercise. *Med Sci Sports Exerc.* 2011;43(7):1334-59.
8. Ingram, L. A., Tomkinson, G. R., d'Unienville, N. M. A., Gower, B., Gleadhill, S., Boyle, T., & Bennett, H. (2024). Optimising the Dose of Static Stretching to Improve Flexibility: A Systematic Review, Meta-analysis and Multivariate Meta-regression. *Sports medicine (Auckland, N.Z.)*, 10.1007/s40279-024-02143-9. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40279-024-02143-9>
9. Król, M., Kupnicka, P., Bosiacki, M., & Chlubek, D. (2022). Mechanisms Underlying Anti-Inflammatory and Anti-Cancer Properties of Stretching—A Review. *International Journal of Molecular Sciences*, 23(17), 10127. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ijms231710127>
10. Mayo Foundation for Medical Education and Research. (2023, November 18). *Stretching: Focus on flexibility*. Mayo Clinic. <https://www.mayoclinic.org/healthy-lifestyle/fitness/in-depth/stretching/art-20047931>
11. *Physical activity and the person with cancer*. American Cancer Society. (2022, March 16). <https://www.cancer.org/cancer/survivorship/be-healthy-after-treatment/physical-activity-and-the-cancer-patient.html>
12. [Benefits of Flexibility and How To Improve It](#)
13. Polero, P., Rebollo-Seco, C., Adsuar, J. C., Pérez-Gómez, J., Rojo-Ramos, J., Manzano-Redondo, F., Garcia-Gordillo, M. Á., & Carlos-Vivas, J. (2021). Physical Activity Recommendations during COVID-19: Narrative Review. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, 18(1), 65. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph18010065>
14. Sattar, S., Haase, K., Kuster, S., Puts, M., Spoelstra, S., Bradley, C., Wildes, T. M., & Alibhai, S. (2021). Falls in older adults with cancer: an updated systematic review of prevalence, injurious falls, and impact on cancer treatment. *Supportive care in cancer : official journal of the Multinational Association of Supportive Care in Cancer*, 29(1), 21–33. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00520-020-05619-2>
15. [Older Adult Falls Data | Older Adult Fall Prevention | CDC](#)

The Importance of Sleep: Script with Animation Notes (FINAL)

[Animator's Note: Start with a peaceful bedroom scene, gradually brightening as if sun is rising]

Narrator: Imagine waking up each morning feeling refreshed and ready to conquer the day—that's the power of a good night's sleep. Sleep is not just a nightly ritual; it's a vital part of our overall health, affecting everything from our mood and memory to our immune system and heart health.

[Animator's Note: Transition to a scene showing various nighttime distractions]

Narrator: This day and age we have many distractions that can keep us up at night (*phone dings?*) or things we'd rather be doing than sleeping (*binge-watching the newest show, perhaps?*)

[Animator's Note: Show a pie chart dividing a 24-hour day, with 1/3 highlighted for sleep]

Narrator: Sleep is so important that we spend a third of our life doing it! Thanks to science, we know sleeping is more than just a time when our body shuts down, and we drift off.

[Animator's Note: Split screen showing "Quantity" and "Quality" of sleep]

Narrator: When we sleep, our body and brain are focused on recovery. To ensure we get the best sleep, we need to focus on two things: the ****quantity**** and the ****quality**** of our sleep.

[Animator's Note: Show a clock or timer indicating 7-9 hours]

Narrator: So how much sleep should we be getting? Well, the National Sleep Foundation recommends that adults should be sleeping between 7 to 9 hours each night [14].

[Animator's Note: Show a brain with lighting up areas representing memory formation, learning, and recharging]

Narrator: When we sleep, our body is better able to form memories, consolidate new things we've learned, and recharge our brains for the next day! When we don't get enough sleep, we are more forgetful, have trouble focusing, and our cat-like reflexes turn into sloth *(turtle)* speed.

[Animator's Note: Show a person juggling various tasks, then looking tired]

Narrator: Life can get crazy busy sometimes, and this can lead to shorter sleep hours so we can get more done. You might think this is a great way to get more done in the day, but not getting the recommended amount of sleep means that we may not be fully ready to face our daily challenges.

[Animator's Note: Illustrate the sleep stages as waves or cycles]

Narrator: Now let's talk about the ****quality of our sleep****. Sleep is made up of different stages: Light, Deep, and REM or otherwise known as Rapid Eye Movement. Throughout one night, we cycle through these stages multiple times, each cycle lasting around 90-120 minutes.

[Animator's Note: Visually represent each sleep stage]

Narrator: Light sleep is the stage between wakefulness and sleep.

Narrator: Deep sleep is the most restorative stage of sleep.

Narrator: And REM sleep is when most of our dreaming occurs.

[Animator's Note show sheep jumping fence/some dream state. Show a graph of sleep stages throughout the night]

Narrator: As the night progresses, the duration of REM sleep increases and the time in deep sleep decreases.

[Animator's Note: Show icons representing physical and mental health, memory, learning, etc.]

Narrator: Each stage of sleep plays a crucial role in maintaining physical and mental health, contributing to memory consolidation, learning, and overall well-being.

[Animator's Note: Show various daily activities (eating, exercising, taking medication) and their impact on sleep quality]

Narrator: But what we do throughout the day, like what we eat, how much we move, and maybe even medications we take, can have a negative impact on the quality of our sleep.

[Animator's Note: Illustrate short-term effects of poor sleep]

Narrator: In the short-term, poor quality sleep can result in feelings of tiredness and low energy throughout the day, making it difficult to stay focused at our jobs, drive safely, and even function in social gatherings

[Animator's Note: Show long-term effects branching out from poor sleep]

Narrator: In the long-term, a lack of sleep can lead to negative mental health outcomes like depression, anxiety, stress, and rumination, which means constantly focusing on negative experiences which can result in emotional distress [4].

Narrator: Poor sleep can also lead to an increased risk of developing common chronic diseases like cardiovascular disease, diabetes, obesity, and infection, and nobody likes to be sick.

[Animator's Note: Transition to infographic-style presentation of statistics]

Narrator: So how are we doing in the US when it comes to poor sleep?

- 2 out of 3 US adults report feeling tired and get insufficient sleep at least once per month.
- And 2 out of 3 adults also report having general sleep problems at least a few times a week.
- And 1 in 3 are sleeping less than 7 hours per night. [2,3]

[Animator's Note: Show a person prioritizing sleep, looking refreshed and healthy]

Narrator: So the main takeaway is that many of us need to work on getting a better night's sleep and prioritizing our rest.

[Animator's Note: Show a person talking to a doctor]

Narrator: And if you're having trouble with your sleep, bring it up to your doctor, so you can work together to find a solution

Narrator: And if your goal is to get better sleep, feel free to check out our video on tips of how to get better sleep

Animation #21: Importance of Sleep Recommendations (OLD)

Imagine waking up each morning feeling refreshed and ready to conquer the day—that's the power of a good night's sleep. Sleep is not just a nightly ritual; it's a vital part of our overall health, affecting everything from our mood and memory to our immune system and heart health.

This day and age we have many distractions that can keep us up at night (*phone dings?*) or things we'd rather be doing than sleeping like binge-watching the newest show, perhaps?

Sleep is so important that we spend a third of our life doing it! Thanks to science, we know sleeping is more than just a time when our body shuts down, and we drift off.

- When we sleep, our body and brain are focused on recovery. To ensure we get the best sleep, we need to focus on two things: the **quantity** and the **quality** of our sleep.
- So how much sleep should we be getting? Well, the National Sleep Foundation recommends that adults should be sleeping between 7 to 9 hours each night [14].
- When we sleep, our body is better able to form memories, consolidate new things we've learned, and recharge our brains for the next day! When we don't get enough sleep, we are more forgetful, have trouble focusing, and our cat-like reflexes turn into sloth (*turtle*) speed.
- Life can get crazy busy sometimes, and this can lead to shorter sleep hours so we can get more done. You might think this is a great way to get more done in the day, but not getting the recommended amount of sleep means that we may not be fully ready to face our daily challenges.
- Now let's talk about the **quality of our sleep**. Sleep is made up of different stages: Light, Deep, and REM or otherwise known as Rapid Eye Movement. Throughout one night, we cycle through these stages multiple times, each cycle lasting around 90-120 minutes.
- Light sleep is the transition period from wakefulness to sleep, where our body starts to relax.
- Deep sleep is the most restorative stage of sleep.
- And REM sleep is when most of our dreaming occurs. [*show sheep jumping fence/some dream state*]
- As the night progresses, the duration of REM sleep increases and the time in deep sleep decreases.
- Each stage of sleep plays a crucial role in maintaining physical and mental health, contributing to memory consolidation, learning, and overall well-being.
- But what we do throughout the day, like what we eat, how much we move, and maybe even medications we take, can have a negative impact on the quality of our sleep.
- In the short-term, poor quality sleep can result in feelings of tiredness and low energy throughout the day, making it difficult to stay focused at our jobs, drive safely, and even function in social gatherings
- In the long-term, a lack of sleep can lead to negative mental health outcomes like depression, anxiety, stress, and rumination, which means constantly focusing on negative experiences which can result in emotional distress [4].
- Poor sleep can also lead to an increased risk of developing common chronic diseases like cardiovascular disease, diabetes, obesity, and infection, and nobody likes to be sick.
- So how are we doing in the US when it comes to poor sleep?
- 2 out of 3 US adults report feeling tired and get insufficient sleep at least once per month.
- And 2 out of 3 adults also report having general sleep problems at least a few times a week.
- And 1 in 3 are sleeping less than 7 hours per night. [2,3]
- So the main takeaway is that many of us need to work on getting a better night's sleep and prioritizing our rest.
- And if you're having trouble with your sleep, bring it up to your doctor, so you can work together to find a solution
- So now if your goal is to get better sleep, feel free to check out our video on tips of how to get better sleep

Resources:

1. <https://www.nhlbi.nih.gov/resources/2011-national-institutes-health-sleep-disorders-research-plan#:~:text=The%20National%20Institutes%20of%20Health,and%20treatment%20of%20sleep%20disorders.>
2. Centers for Disease C, Prevention. Effect of short sleep duration on daily activities--United States, 2005-2008. MMWR Morb Mortal Wkly Rep. 2011;60(8):239-42.
3. Liu Y, Wheaton AG, Chapman DP, Croft JB. Sleep duration and chronic diseases among U.S. adults age 45 years and older: evidence from the 2010 Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System. Sleep. 2013;36(10):1421-7.
4. <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8651630/>

https://www.nhlbi.nih.gov/files/docs/public/sleep/healthy_sleep.pdf;

<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/29073412/>

<https://www.hopkinsmedicine.org/health/wellness-and-prevention/depression-and-sleep-understanding-the-connection>

Importance of Sleep Recommendations (OLD)

- Welcome to Healthy Buckeyes. This video discusses sleep recommendations and the importance of getting good sleep.
- This day and age we have many distractions that can keep us up at night (phone dings?) or things we'd rather be doing than sleeping (binge-watching the newest show, perhaps?)
- But getting a good night's sleep doesn't only mean we won't feel as tired the next morning. Good quality sleep benefits our physical and mental health in the short and long term.
- Sleep is such an important process that we should actually be spending one-third of our day doing it! The National Sleep Foundation suggests sleeping between 7 to 9 hours for adults each night (26-64 years old) and between 7 to 8 hours for adults over 64 [14].
- WHAT IS SLEEP: Thanks to sleep research, we know sleeping is more than just a time when our body shuts down and we drift off. During sleep your body and brain are actually still very active. Not only is the amount of time you are asleep important, but also how much restorative sleep you're getting is crucial. Restorative sleep is one of the 4 stages of sleep, called Rapid Eye Movement (REM). This stage occurs about 90 minutes after you fall asleep, and there are multiple cycles of REM throughout one night of sleep. This is what makes us feel rested and energized for the day ahead!
- Often people cut back on the amount of sleep they get due to other responsibilities. You might think this is an easy way to get more hours in the day! But not getting the recommended amount of sleep can actually have many negative side effects.
- When we sleep, our body is able to better form memories, consolidate new things we've learned, and recharge our brains for the next day! When we don't get enough sleep, we are more forgetful, have trouble focusing, and may not be able to respond quickly.
- Daytime sleepiness can interfere with our jobs, driving, and social functioning.
- Long term, a lack of sleep can lead to mental health/mood issues. People with insomnia for example, may have 10x the risk of developing depression than people who get a good nights sleep. Similarly, among people with depression, up to 75% have trouble falling asleep or staying asleep.
- There are even some chronic health conditions that can develop from too little sleep over time, like diabetes, cardiovascular disease, obesity, and having a higher susceptibility to infections (and nobody has time to be sick!)
- Now remember, you aren't alone in this. Over 70% of U.S. adults say they feel tired and get insufficient sleep at least once per month [1], 65% report having general sleep problems at least a few times a week [1], and over 35% are sleeping less than 7 hours per night [2,3].
- There are lots of us out there that need to work on getting a better nights sleep and prioritizing our rest!
- And remember -- if you think your sleep habits might be more extreme than simply not getting enough, its always worth bringing up your sleep concerns with your doctor to make sure there is nothing else more serious going on. There are many sleep conditions: insomnia, sleep apnea, restless leg syndrome, narcolepsy, to name a few.
- Okay so we see that sleep is really important for us to feel good and for our health...If you are thinking, well this sounds great and I want to have good sleep, but how can I start? In another video we will provide some actionable tips for a better night's sleep.

Resources:

2. <https://www.nhlbi.nih.gov/resources/2011-national-institutes-health-sleep-disorders-research-plan#:~:text=The%20National%20Institutes%20of%20Health,and%20treatment%20of%20sleep%20disorders.>
3. Centers for Disease C, Prevention. Effect of short sleep duration on daily activities--United States, 2005-2008. MMWR Morb Mortal Wkly Rep. 2011;60(8):239-42.

5. Liu Y, Wheaton AG, Chapman DP, Croft JB. Sleep duration and chronic diseases among U.S. adults age 45 years and older: evidence from the 2010 Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System. *Sleep*. 2013;36(10):1421-7.

https://www.nhlbi.nih.gov/files/docs/public/sleep/healthy_sleep.pdf;

<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/29073412/>

<https://www.hopkinsmedicine.org/health/wellness-and-prevention/depression-and-sleep-understanding-the-connection>

Animation #22: Sleep Hygiene

Welcome! In this video, we'll review some *sleep hygiene tips* to improve your sleep. Sleep hygiene involves optimizing your sleep environment and building some healthy sleepy habits.

Good sleep hygiene often includes:

- Setting ourselves up for good nights sleep by engaging in healthy habits throughout the day
- Following a consistent bedtime routine and sleep schedule
- And, setting up our bedroom for a restful night of sleep

Let's dive in!

[Daytime Activities Section]

Our activities throughout the day, from the moment we wake up to right before bed, play an important role in the quality of our sleep. Let's start by going over what we can do while we're awake to improve our sleep:

- **Daytime Tip # 1: Start each Day with Sunlight**
After waking up, try to spend some time in natural light. Sunlight is crucial for regulating our body's internal clock, also known as the circadian rhythm.
- Sunlight in the morning helps our internal clock know when it's time to be awake and when it's time be asleep.
- Just 30 minutes of natural light a day can improve sleep quality. And if you want to get the most bang out of your buck, then aim to get natural sunlight, which is far more impactful than indoor lighting on our circadian rhythm.
- **Daytime Tip # 2: Exercise Regularly**
Regular exercise helps us achieve deeper, more restful sleep. Moderate to vigorous activity, like a brisk walk or bike ride, can help you fall asleep faster and experience fewer night-time awakenings. Exercising in the morning has the added benefit of stimulating early melatonin release in the evening, which can promote sleepiness at bedtime. Aim for at least 30 minutes of moderate exercise, five days a week.
- **Daytime Tip # 3: Nap Wisely**
Naps can recharge you during a demanding day. But try to keep them short—less than 30 minutes—and avoid napping late in the afternoon so that it doesn't affect your ability to sleep at night.
- **Daytime Tip # 4: Eat Regularly, Avoid Late Heavy Meals**
Eating meals at regular intervals supports better sleep, but avoid eating heavy meals close to bedtime. Eating late can signal your body to stay alert for digestion rather than winding down for sleep. Reducing caffeine intake in the afternoon and limiting fluids an hour before bed can also prevent night-time awakenings.
- **Daytime Tip # 5: Limit Alcohol Consumption**
While alcohol might make it easier to fall asleep initially, it often disrupts your sleep later in the night as

your body metabolizes the alcohol, leading to poorer sleep quality and less REM sleep, the most restorative stage of sleep.

[Evening Activities Section]

Now that we've reviewed what we can do during the day, let's go over what we can do at night to improve our sleep quality. In the evening, there are several practices that can set you up for a good night's sleep:

- **Nighttime tip #1: Limiting Screen Time Before Bed**

Reducing screen time an hour before bed can also improve sleep quality, as screens emit blue light, which can delay melatonin release. So do your best to find new bed-time activities that will get you ready for bed.

- **Nighttime tip #2: Wind Down with a Bedtime Routine**

To help our bodies prepare for sleep, it's important to establish a calming routine before bed, like reading or gentle stretching, to signal your body that it's time to rest.

- **Nighttime tip #3: Create a Sleep-Friendly Environment**

Make your bedroom a restful space by keeping it cool, dark, and quiet. And don't worry if you don't have blackout curtains or mask, you can start using an eye mask to create a dark environment.

[Closing]

Practicing healthy habits during the day and creating a calming environment at night can make a big difference in the quality of your sleep. Try incorporating these tips for better, more restful nights. Now go get snoozing!

[Old Version]

In this video, we are talking about ways to improve our sleep. Sleep hygiene is a term that encompasses your sleep environment and your behaviors/habits. Good sleep hygiene includes having a consistent sleep schedule, following a bedtime routine, forming healthy habits, and optimizing your bedroom for sleep (1). You can improve your sleep hygiene with virtually no cost or risk involved.

- Activities that we do during the day, from when we get up in the morning to right before heading to bed, affect our sleep. These activities can either help promote good sleep or make it more challenging to get restful sleep.

Daytime Activities:

- For example, after waking up it is suggested to spend time in bright light. Daylight is important to regulate sleep patterns. Waking up with the sun or in bright light will help train the body's internal clock (your circadian rhythm) to expect wake time and sleep time. Direct sunlight has up to 10,000 lux (even bright office lighting is only about 500 lux), so outdoor sunlight has a big impact and is best if possible. But in general, at least 30 minutes of natural sunlight each day will help with nighttime sleep (2).

- Also, regular exercise can help us achieve deeper sleep. Moderate to vigorous exercise can decrease the amount of time it takes to fall asleep and reduce the amount of unwanted night time awakenings. If you are able to exercise in the morning, it may help stimulate earlier melatonin release (a hormone that helps you sleep) in the evening, and you'll have a chance to get more morning light – two habits in one! Make it a goal to complete 30 minutes of exercise, 5 days a week (3).

- Naps can be helpful to keep up with a demanding day, however they should be relatively short (<30 minutes) and occur before mid-afternoon (1).

- Try to eat meals at regularly timed intervals, but especially stay away from late night eating. Your body will be focused on digesting food instead of getting ready for sleep (1). And cut down on the amount of caffeine consumed in the afternoon in order to be ready for bed! If bathroom trips tend to wake you up, try reducing your fluid intake within an hour of bedtime.

- While it may seem like alcohol makes it easier to fall asleep, its effects wear off later in the night, disrupting your sleep as your liver continues to metabolize the alcohol (1). Alcohol also reduces the amount of REM sleep (the most restful sleep stage we learned about last week), making you feel more sleepy the next day (4).

Evening Activities:

- In the evening, there are a variety of measures we can take to help get better sleep that night.

Practicing healthy habits during the day and creating a good sleep environment will help you achieve your best nights sleep.

Resources: 1) <https://www.sleepfoundation.org/sleep-hygiene> 2) <https://www.sleepfoundation.org/bedroom-environment/light-and-sleep> . 3) <https://www.sleepfoundation.org/physical-activity/exercise-and-sleep> 4) <https://www.sleepfoundation.org/nutrition/alcohol-and-sleep> <https://www.thensf.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/11/NSF-2022-BSS-Infographic.pdf>; <https://www.nhlbi.nih.gov/resources/your-guide-healthy-sleep>; <https://sleepeducation.org/healthy-sleep/healthy-sleep-habits/>;

Benefits of a Healthy Weight

Healthy Weight: Short- and Long-Term Benefits

[Scene 1: Welcome & What to Expect Today]

(Gentle, hopeful music — visuals of survivors walking, preparing meals, smiling with caregivers)

Narrator (voiceover):

“Welcome! In this video, we’ll explore something very important for cancer survivors and caregivers — achieving and maintaining a healthy weight.

Over the next few minutes, we’ll look at what you can expect to see in both the short term and the long term as your body adapts and strengthens.

Let’s start with the short-term benefits — the positive changes that often begin within just a few weeks or months.

Think of these as the early rewards on your path toward better health.”

[Scene 2: Short-Term Benefits]

(Calm transitions — one benefit per short vignette or icon animation)

Narrator (voiceover):

“As these changes take place, you may notice improvements in several areas. Let’s walk through them.”

1. Better blood sugar and insulin balance

“You may start to notice that your blood sugar and insulin levels become more stable, which means fewer spikes after meals and more steady energy throughout the day.”

2. Lower blood pressure and less strain on your heart

“As extra weight comes off, the pressure on your heart and blood vessels eases. Many people see gentle improvements in their blood pressure and overall heart health.”

3. Better sleep and easier breathing

“Carrying less weight can also make it easier to breathe and sleep deeply. So, you might notice fewer nighttime interruptions and more daytime energy.”

4. Easier movement and less joint discomfort

“With less strain on your knees, hips, and back, even simple movements like getting up, walking, or taking the stairs — can start to feel smoother and more effortless.”

5. More energy and a brighter mood

“As your body runs more efficiently, many people feel more energetic and motivated — positive feelings that make healthy habits easier to maintain.”

[Scene 3: Transition to Long-Term Benefits]

(Visuals shift to a wider, more hopeful tone — people engaging in activities, laughing, walking outdoors)

Narrator (voiceover):

“Over time, these early wins build into powerful, long-term benefits. Let’s go over some of the long-term benefits of maintaining a healthy weight”

[Scene 4: Long-Term Benefits]

Narrator (voiceover):

“Maintaining a healthy weight can lower your risk of heart disease, diabetes, and several types of cancer, including colorectal cancer.^{1,2}

By calming inflammation and supporting healthy metabolism, your body’s organs — like the heart, liver, and kidneys — can function better for longer.^{3,4}

It also helps protect your joints and muscles, keeping you strong, mobile, and independent as you age.³

And perhaps most importantly, many people experience a better overall quality of life — more energy, better sleep, and greater confidence in daily living.”⁵

[Scene 5: Closing Message]

(Gentle fade to uplifting music — warm visuals of small daily actions: walking, cooking, sharing meals)

Narrator (voiceover):

“Remember — these benefits don’t come from perfection; they come from consistency.

Even small, realistic steps toward a healthier weight can create meaningful changes — starting today, and lasting for years to come.”

References (will put in Zotero later, don’t have Zotero downloaded on this laptop)

1. [Preventing Cancer, Cardiovascular Disease, and Diabetes | Circulation](#)
2. [Excess Body Weight and Cancer Risk | American Cancer Society](#)
3. [Health Risks of Overweight & Obesity - NIDDK](#)

4. [The Related Metabolic Diseases and Treatments of Obesity](#)

5. [Obesity, functional mobility and quality of life](#)

Welcome & What to Expect Today

Narrator (voiceover): “Welcome! In this video, we’re going to explore something very important for cancer survivors and caregivers: achieving and maintaining a healthy weight. Over the next few minutes, we’ll walk through what you can expect to see in the short term, and also in the long term, as your body adapts and strengthens.

Narrator (voiceover): “Let’s begin by looking at the short-term benefits, the changes that often begin to happen within weeks or months, as your body adjusts to healthier habits and weight. Think of these as the ‘early rewards’ on your path forward.”

[Scene 2: Short-Term Benefits — with visual cues and transitions between points]

Narrator (voiceover): “As these shifts take place, you may notice improvements in several areas. Let’s walk through them one by one:”

[Short-Term Benefits — condensed version] 1. Better blood sugar and insulin response

Narrator (voiceover): “You might start seeing your blood sugar and insulin levels stabilize more gently — less spiking after meals and lower fasting numbers. This helps your body better manage energy intake.”

2. Lower blood pressure and gentler strain on your heart “And as you lose extra weight, the pressure on your blood vessels and heart eases. Many people notice reductions in both systolic and diastolic blood pressure, easing cardiovascular stress.”

3. Reduced inflammation and stress signals “Fat tissue, especially around organs, sends out inflammatory signals that stress many body systems. When you lose excess fat, those signals tend to dial back — meaning lower levels of markers like CRP and less internal ‘noise’ in your system.”

4. Improved sleep / easier breathing “Carrying less weight can relieve pressure on your breathing, especially at night. If you’ve had sleep disruptions or mild breathing issues, you might notice deeper, less interrupted sleep and more daytime energy.”

5. Less joint strain; easier movement “With less weight to carry, your knees, hips, back, and joints often feel better. And everyday movements — getting up, walking, bending — may become noticeably smoother and less tiring.”

6. More energy, confidence, and better mood “Lastly, as your body adjusts and starts to run more efficiently, many people feel more energetic, more confident, and more motivated — which helps reinforce healthy habits in day-to-day life.”

Narrator: “Over time, these small changes can add up to powerful long-term benefits.”

“Maintaining a healthy weight can lower your risk of heart disease, diabetes, and several cancers, including colorectal cancer.”

“By easing inflammation and supporting healthy metabolism, your body’s organs — like the liver, kidneys, and heart — can work better for longer.”

“And it also helps protect your joints and muscles, keeping you mobile and independent as you age.”

“Remember — these benefits don’t come from perfection. They come from consistency. Even small, realistic steps toward a healthier weight can have meaningful effects — starting today, and lasting for years to come.”

Narrator: Welcome back! In this video, we'll uncover why maintaining a healthy weight is about so much more than a number on the scale. A healthy weight allows your body to function at its best and helps protect your health for years to come.

Narrator: In our last video, we explored what a “healthy weight” is. Now, let's look at *why* it matters.

Let's get started by reviewing the short-term benefits of maintaining a healthy weight.

[SHOW, DON'T SAY: Short-Term Benefits]

Narrator: One of the first things you'll notice is more energy and stamina.

When your weight is in a healthy range, everyday tasks—like climbing stairs, walking the dog, or playing with your grandkids—feel easier.

Narrator: Another benefit is improved mental and emotional health.

Maintaining a healthy weight is linked to better mood and reduced stress, anxiety, and depression (Swencionis et al., 2013). A balanced lifestyle with regular activity can also improve sleep quality and help regulate stress levels.

[SHOW, DON'T SAY: Short-term benefits being checked off—transition to long-term benefits.]

[SHOW, DON'T SAY: Long-Term Benefits]

Narrator: Now, let's talk about the big-picture benefits—those that protect your health in the long run.

Maintaining a healthy weight isn't just about reducing numbers on a scale—it's one of the most powerful things you can do for long-term health. In fact, experts predict that by 2030, obesity may surpass tobacco as the leading preventable cause of cancer (Irwin et al., 2023).

Narrator: First, maintaining a healthy weight helps lower your risk of chronic diseases.

Carrying excess weight increases the risk of conditions like heart disease, high blood pressure, stroke, type 2 diabetes, liver disease, and gallstones. Taking steps to maintain a healthy weight can significantly reduce these risks (Rock et al., 2020).

Another important benefit is cancer prevention.

A healthy weight lowers your risk for 13 types of cancer, which together make up about 40% of all cancers diagnosed in the U.S. each year (CDC, n.d.).

It also protects your joints and bones.

By reducing stress on your joints, maintaining a healthy weight can ease discomfort and help prevent or slow the progression of conditions like osteoarthritis.

And as we look to the future, a healthy weight supports healthy aging.

It helps you stay strong, steady, and mobile—reducing the risk of falls and helping you remain independent for longer (Thiamwong et al., 2023).

[SHOW, DON'T SAY: Long-term benefits being checked off.]

[SHOW, DON'T SAY: Encouragement and Next Steps]

Narrator: If reaching or maintaining a healthy weight feels like a challenge, remember that it's not about perfection or quick fixes. Even small, consistent changes—like adding a few more steps each day or swapping sugary drinks for water—can make a meaningful difference over time.

A balanced diet and regular physical activity are proven, evidence-based strategies for reaching a healthier weight, and they're steps you can take at your own pace (Rock et al., 2020).

Be sure to check out our other videos on physical activity and healthy eating for simple, practical tips you can start today.

Narrator: Thanks for watching—and remember to celebrate every win, no matter how small. Every step toward a healthier you is worth celebrating!

References (APA Style)

- Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (n.d.). *Obesity and cancer*. <https://www.cdc.gov/cancer/risk-factors/obesity.html>
- Irwin, M. L., Sears, D. D., & Ligibel, J. (2023). Translational and transdisciplinary research in energy balance and cancer: Past is prologue. *JNCI Monographs*, 2023(61), 1–2. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jncimonographs/lgad009>
- Ostendorf, D. M., Caldwell, A. E., Creasy, S. A., et al. (2019). Physical activity energy expenditure and total daily energy expenditure in successful weight loss maintainers. *Obesity*, 27(3), 496–504. <https://doi.org/10.1002/oby.22373>
- Rock, C. L., Thomson, C., Gansler, T., et al. (2020). American Cancer Society guideline for diet and physical activity for cancer prevention. *CA: A Cancer Journal for Clinicians*, 70(4), 245–271. <https://doi.org/10.3322/caac.21591>
- Swencionis, C., Wylie-Rosett, J., Lent, M. R., et al. (2013). Weight change, psychological well-being, and vitality in adults participating in a cognitive–behavioral weight loss program. *Health Psychology*, 32(4), 439–446. <https://doi.org/10.1037/a0029186>
- Thiamwong, L., Xie, R., Conner, N. E., Renziehausen, J. M., Ojo, E. O., & Stout, J. R. (2023). Body composition, fear of falling, and balance performance in community-dwelling older adults. *Translational Medicine of Aging*, 7, 80–86. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tma.2023.06.002>

Title: Understanding Ultra-Processed Foods & Your Health

Visuals: A shopping cart filled with fresh, whole foods transitioning into a conveyor belt of ultra-processed packaged foods.

[Do not narrate: Introduction]

Narrator:

Hi there! Today, we're diving into an important topic that can have a big impact on your health—**ultra-processed foods**.

We'll explore 3 topics:

- What ultra-processed foods are
- How they can affect your health
- And simple ways to limit them and choose healthier alternatives

Let's get started!

[Do not narrate: What Are Ultra-Processed Foods?]

Narrator:

Visuals: Split screen – left side (green background) comes in with plate of nutrient dense foods, and then right side (red background) comes in with sugar, salt, and any candy/snacks VYOND has to represent the 2 recommendations from the DGA (+nutrient dense foods, -ultra-processed).

The Dietary Guidelines for Americans, or DGA, encourages us to focus on **nutrient-dense** foods—or foods that provide essential vitamins, minerals, and fiber.. like fruits, vegetables, and lean proteins.

The DGA also advises limiting foods containing excess added sugars, sodium, or unhealthy fats commonly found in processed foods.

Visuals: A conveyor belt producing boxed and bagged foods with ingredient labels showing long, unrecognizable lists.

Ultra-processed foods are **industrial products** that go through multiple processing steps that **remove healthy portions of the food** and add chemicals that may not be so healthy, but often to reduce price and prolong shelf-life. They often contain:

- Artificial flavors, colors, and preservatives
- Added sugars, salt, and unhealthy fats
- Unrecognizable chemical ingredients
- And low amounts of real, whole-food ingredients. Which is what is recommended.

Examples of ultra-processed foods include packaged snacks, sugary drinks, instant noodles, frozen meals, and fast food.

[Do not narrate: How Do Ultra-Processed Foods Impact Your Health?]

Narrator:

Now that we know what ultra-processed foods are, let's discuss why it's important to limit or avoid them entirely.

Overeating of these ultra-processed foods can increase the risk of developing:

- **Obesity and weight gain** – These foods are often high in **calories but low in nutrients**, leading to overeating.
- They can also lead to **Increased risk of some of the most common chronic diseases** – such as **cancer, heart disease, and type 2 diabetes**.
- And lastly, processed foods are the leading source of **sodium**, which increases the risk of **high blood pressure and cardiovascular disease**.

On the other hand, limiting ultra-processed foods can help you

- Maintain a healthy weight
- Reduce the risk of chronic diseases
- And support overall well-being!

[Do not narrate: How Can You Reduce Ultra-Processed Foods?]

Visuals: A person swapping a processed snack for an apple, a grocery cart filled with fresh foods, and a home-cooked meal being prepared.

Narrator:

We understand that eliminating ultra-processed foods from your diet would be pretty difficult... But the good news is that making small changes can have a **big impact!** Let me share some tips to cut down on ultra-processed foods:

- **First, start with simple swaps** – Choose **whole grains** instead of refined grains, drink **water** instead of sugary beverages, and try to snack on **nuts and fruit** every once in a while, instead of chips.
- **Cook more at home** – Preparing your meals allows you to control ingredients, avoid hidden additives, and save money.
- **Read labels** – If the ingredient list is long and full of things you **can't pronounce**, it's probably ultra-processed. Look for less ingredients in packaged products.
- **Shop smart** – Stick to the **outer aisles** of the grocery store where fresh produce, whole grains, and lean proteins are found.

[Do not narrate: Conclusion]

Narrator:

By limiting ultra-processed foods in your diet and swapping with whole and less-processed foods, you're fueling your body with the nutrients it needs to thrive!

...Now..let's make **every bite count** for a healthier future!

Visuals: A plate full of fresh, whole foods with the words: "Nourish your body. Make the change today!"

What is a healthy weight script

Revised Script

Hi there! Today, we're going to talk about something that plays a big role in your overall health: maintaining a healthy weight. In this video, we'll explore what's considered a healthy weight, why it can be challenging to achieve, and how the idea of energy balance can guide us toward healthier habits.

What is a “healthy weight”?

According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC), a healthy weight corresponds to a Body Mass Index (BMI) between 18.5 and 24.9 (CDC, n.d.).

What is BMI?

BMI is a simple measure that relates body weight to height. It's calculated by dividing your weight in kilograms by your height in meters squared, or you can use an online BMI calculator.

- A BMI of less than 18.5 is considered underweight.
- Between 18.5 and 24.9 is normal weight.
- Between 25.0 and 29.9 is overweight.
- 30 or above is considered obese.

Why is this important?

In the U.S., nearly 1 in 3 adults (about 31%) are overweight, and more than 2 in 5 adults (over 42%) have obesity (Hales et al., 2018). These numbers show that many people face challenges with weight, and it's not simply a matter of personal willpower. Life is complex—stress, demanding schedules, family responsibilities, limited access to affordable healthy foods, and fewer safe places for physical activity all play a role (Romieu et al., 2017).

In fact, experts estimate that by 2030, obesity will surpass tobacco as the leading preventable risk factor for cancer (Irwin et al., 2023). This highlights why even small, realistic steps to improve weight management can be so meaningful for your overall health and recovery.

Let's review energy balance now and how it can guide us to a healthy weight.

Managing weight comes down to energy balance—the relationship between the energy we take in from food and drinks and the energy our bodies burn through movement, activity, and simply staying alive.

- When we consistently consume more energy than we use, the extra energy is stored as fat.
- When we consume less than we expend, we lose weight.

Think of energy balance like a **budget**—if we take in more than we spend, the “extra” gets stored. Our modern environment—with its abundance of high-calorie foods and sedentary routines—makes it easy for that balance to tip in the wrong direction (Hill et al., 2012). But the good news is that small, sustainable changes in eating and movement can have a big impact over time.

Why This Matters for You

The mHealthy Buckeyes program is designed to help you find practical ways to bring your energy balance closer to where you want it to be—through small, meaningful habits like moving more throughout your day, making healthier food choices, and managing stress. These steps can support your health, your energy, and your quality of life.

Transition to Next Video

In our next video, we’ll explore the benefits of maintaining a healthy weight—from boosting your energy to protecting you from chronic conditions. We hope you’ll join us!

References (APA Style)

- Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (n.d.). *About adult BMI*. https://www.cdc.gov/healthyweight/assessing/bmi/adult_bmi/index.html
- Hales, C. M., Fryar, C. D., Carroll, M. D., Freedman, D. S., & Ogden, C. L. (2018). *Differences in obesity prevalence by demographic characteristics and urbanization level among adults: United States, 2013–2016*. National Center for Health Statistics.
- Hill, J. O., Wyatt, H. R., & Peters, J. C. (2012). Energy balance and obesity. *Circulation*, 126(1), 126–132. <https://doi.org/10.1161/CIRCULATIONAHA.111.087213>
- Irwin, M. L., Sears, D. D., & Ligibel, J. (2023). Translational and transdisciplinary research in energy balance and cancer: Past is prologue. *JNCI Monographs*, 2023(61), 1–2. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jncimonographs/lgad009>
- Romieu, I., Dossus, L., Barquera, S., Blottière, H. M., Franks, P. W., Gunter, M., ... & Willett, W. C. (2017). Energy balance and obesity: What are the main drivers? *Cancer Causes & Control*, 28(3), 247–258. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10552-017-0869-z>

Getting the Most from Your Grains

Narrator (warm tone):

Welcome back! Today, we're talking about grains — foods that fuel your body, support digestion, and can help lower your risk of some chronic diseases.

Grains are the seeds of grasses like wheat, rice, oats, and corn — that are used to make bread, pasta, tortillas, cereal, and even popcorn. But not all grains are created equal.

Narrator:

There are **two** main types: whole grains and refined grains.

- Whole grains contain all three parts — the bran, germ, and endosperm — giving you fiber, B vitamins, and energy. Examples include whole-wheat bread, oatmeal, quinoa, and brown rice.
- Refined grains are milled to remove the bran and germ. This makes them softer and last longer, but strips away fiber and nutrients, leading to quicker digestion and higher blood sugar spikes. Examples include white bread, white rice, and sugary cereals.

So, **why** do whole grains matter?

- Well, they're rich in fiber, which supports digestion, helps you feel full, and lowers your risk of heart disease, stroke, obesity, and type 2 diabetes.
- They provide steady energy from complex carbs that break down slowly.
- They supply key nutrients like B vitamins, magnesium, and selenium — all supporting energy, immunity, and reduced inflammation.
- And for cancer survivors, the American Cancer Society notes that eating whole grains may help reduce colorectal cancer risk and support a healthy weight.

So **how much** do you need?

The Dietary Guidelines for Americans recommend about 6 ounce-equivalents of grains daily — with at least half from whole grains.

Examples of one ounce-equivalent:

- 1 slice of bread

- ½ cup cooked rice, quinoa, or oatmeal
- 3 cups air-popped popcorn

That means aiming for at least 3 ounce-equivalents of whole grains each day.

Let's go over some easy ways to add more grains to your diet:

- Swap it out: choose brown rice, whole-wheat pasta, or oatmeal instead of refined versions.
- Snack smart: go for plain air-popped popcorn.
- Mix it up: try quinoa or barley in soups and salads.
- Read labels: pick products that list “whole” as the first ingredient — like “whole wheat” or “whole oats.”

Whole grains don't just fill your plate — they fuel your life. They're a simple, powerful way to support your health, lower chronic disease risk, and feel your best every day. Start small, make swaps, and keep going — because eating better truly means living better.

Getting the Most from Your Grains

Narrator (welcoming tone): -----[INTRODUCTION]-----

Welcome back! Today, we'll talk about something that can power your body, support your digestion, and even help reduce your risk of some chronic diseases — grains!

Let's kick things off by understanding the basics – grains are the seeds of grasses like wheat, rice, oats, and corn. And they're used to make everyday foods like bread, pasta, tortillas, cereal, and even popcorn.

However, not all grains are the same, and some offer different nutritional values.

There are **two main types of grains: whole grains** and **refined grains**¹

- **Whole grains** contain all three parts of the grain: the **bran**, **germ**, and **endosperm**.^{2,3} Which makes sense why they're called ***whole grains***, right? Get it, they have the ***whole*** grain.
 - The bran and germ are **packed** with fiber, B vitamins, and important nutrients your body needs.¹⁻³
 - And the endosperm, which is mostly starch, provides energy ¹⁻³
 - Examples of whole grains include: whole wheat bread, whole grain pasta, oatmeal, and quinoa.
- **Refined grains**, on the other hand, are milled to **remove** the bran and germ.²⁻⁴ This process gives them some benefits like a finer texture and longer shelf life — but the **problem** is that this removes much of the fiber and key nutrients. And without that fiber, they're digested more quickly, which can lead to **faster and bigger spikes in blood sugar**^{2,4} **which is linked to common diseases like diabetes**.
 - Refined grains are typically made from white flour or enriched flour.
 - And some common examples of refined grains are white bread, white rice, baked goods, sugary cereals, and most crackers and pretzels.

Narrator: -----[THE WHY]-----

Yikes! These are pretty common foods, right? Don't worry, we'll give you some tips at the end of this video to help you introduce more whole grains into your life. But before we do that, let's review ***why whole*** grains are essential for our health.

[Scene: person running or working out and happy/energetic]

- To start, whole grains are rich in **fiber**
 - And fiber supports digestion, which helps you feel full and can prevent overeating.

- Fiber can also help improve cholesterol levels, **and** lower your risk of heart disease, stroke, obesity, and type 2 diabetes^{1,4}
- Whole grains also give your body **lasting energy**, thanks to complex carbohydrates that allow foods to be broken down more slowly for those activity-packed days.^{1,2,4}

[Scene: person eating colorful meal, and happy and full at the end]

- Whole grains also contain important nutrients like **B vitamins, magnesium, and selenium**, which help with energy production, immune support, and reducing inflammation^{1,2,4}
- And here's something important for cancer survivors and caregivers to know:
 - The American Cancer Society states that research suggests eating **whole grains may help lower the risk of colorectal cancer**.⁵
 - They also note that eating whole grains and other high-fiber foods also **supports a healthy weight**, and managing weight is an important part of reducing cancer risk overall.⁵

Narrator: -----[HOW MUCH]-----

Great, we know why whole grains are beneficial, so **how much** should we be eating?

Well, the **Dietary Guidelines for Americans** recommend that **most adults aim for 6 ounce-equivalents of grains each day** — and **at least half of those should be whole grains**.¹

But what exactly **is** an ounce-equivalent? Here are some easy examples:

- 1 slice of bread
- ½ cup of cooked rice, quinoa, or oatmeal
- 3 cups of air-popped popcorn

Remember, we want at least **half** of our grains to be whole grains, so try to get **at least 3 ounce-equivalents from whole grains** every day.

Narrator: -----[HOW TO EAT MORE]-----

And if you're wondering how you can eat more **whole** grains, it's easier than you might think!

Here are some simple tips to get started:

- **Swap it out:** Choose brown rice instead of white rice, whole wheat pasta instead of regular pasta, or instead of sugary cereals, try whole grain cereals with less sugar or even oatmeal.
- **Snack smart:** Air-popped popcorn is a whole grain and a tasty snack! But limit or avoid added butter and salt.
- **Mix it up:** Try out different whole grains like quinoa and barley in soups, salads, or side dishes.
- **And make sure to read labels:** Look for the word “**whole**” as the first ingredient, like “**whole** wheat” or “**whole** oats”.

Narrator: -----[CLOSING]-----

Whole grains do more than fill your plate — they fuel your life. They're a simple, powerful way to care for your body, reduce your risk of chronic diseases, and support your journey toward better health.

Start small, make swaps, and keep going. It's not just about eating better — it's about living better, and whole grains can help get you there!

References:

1. Dietary Guidelines for Americans, 2020-2025.
2. Jones JM, García CG, Braun HJ. Perspective: Whole and Refined Grains and Health—Evidence Supporting “Make Half Your Grains Whole.” *Advances in Nutrition*. 2020;11(3):492-506. doi:10.1093/advances/nmz114
3. Mayo Clinic. Nutrition and healthy eating. December 10, 2022. Accessed July 14, 2025. https://www.mayoclinic.org/healthy-lifestyle/nutrition-and-healthy-eating/in-depth/whole-grains/art-20047826?utm_source=chatgpt.com
4. American Heart Association. Get to Know Grains: Why You Need Them, and What to Look For. June 25, 2024. Accessed July 14, 2025. <https://www.heart.org/en/healthy-living/healthy-eating/eat-smart/nutrition-basics/whole-grains-refined-grains-and-dietary-fiber>
5. Rock CL, Thomson C, Gansler T, et al. American Cancer Society guideline for diet and physical activity for cancer prevention. *CA A Cancer J Clinicians*. 2020;70(4):245-271. doi:10.3322/caac.21591

Script Title:

Live Longer, Stay Stronger: The Lasting Benefits of Exercise

Voiceover Script (What the narrator says):

Narrator (Voiceover):

“In today’s video, we’ll explore how moving your body doesn’t just make you feel better right now—it also helps you stay strong and live longer.”

Narrator (Voiceover):

“Research shows that every additional 1,000 steps per day is associated with a **15% lower risk of dying from any cause** (Banach et al., 2023). Moreover, walking as few as **7,000 steps a day** has been linked to a **47% reduction in overall mortality**, plus notable declines in heart disease, cancer, dementia, depression, and falls (Ding et al., 2025). Even through small increases, the benefits add up.”

Narrator (Voiceover):

“Physical activity also helps protect against several cancers—including bladder, breast, colon, endometrial, esophageal, kidney, and stomach cancers (McTiernan, 2019; CDC, 2024). For those diagnosed with cancer, being active after diagnosis can reduce cancer-specific or all-cause mortality by up to **50%** (McTiernan, 2019).”

Narrator (Voiceover):

“Heart disease remains one of the top non-cancer threats to long-term survivors. Yet exercise strengthens your heart, lowers blood pressure, improves cholesterol, and keeps blood vessels healthy (Del Pozo Cruz et al., 2022).”

Narrator (Voiceover):

“Exercise also boosts well-being. Just **11 minutes of moderate activity per day**—like brisk walking or yoga—can cut cardiovascular risk by **17%**, lower cancer risk by **7%**, and reduce early death risk by **23%** (NIHR Evidence, 2023; *Exercise*, Wikipedia, 2025).”

Narrator (Voiceover):

“And for our bones and muscles: being active builds bone density, preserves strength, and lowers the risk of fractures and osteoporosis, while also helping maintain a healthy weight—which itself supports long-term health (Physical Activity Guidelines, U.S., 2018).”

Narrator (Closing Voiceover):

“In short: stronger hearts, lower cancer risk, better bones, and longer life—all possible through movement. A gym isn’t required. Start small, stay consistent, and remember: every step today builds a healthier tomorrow.”

Narrator (Final Line):

“Because long-term health begins with your very next move.”

Visual Cues (What Appears on Screen but Is Not Said):

- **Opening Title Screen:** “*Live Longer, Stay Stronger: The Lasting Benefits of Exercise*”
 - **After “1,000 steps per day...”:** Display a graphic of a footprint icon + “15% ↓ all-cause mortality”
 - **After “7,000 steps a day...”:** Overlay stat graphic: “47% ↓ risk of death; 25% ↓ heart disease; 37% ↓ cancer; 22% ↓ depression; 28% ↓ falls”
 - **When listing cancers:** Show icons or text for each cancer: bladder, breast, colon, endometrial, esophageal, kidney, stomach.
 - **When referring to “up to 50% reduction” post-diagnosis:** Overlay text: “Up to 50% ↓ mortality for cancer survivors”
 - **Heart benefits section:** Show icons of a beating heart, blood pressure monitor, heart artery, cholesterol symbol.
 - **“11 minutes a day...” stat:** Display “11 min/day = 17% ↓ CVD risk • 7% ↓ cancer • 23% ↓ early death”
 - **Bones & muscles:** Show visuals of strong leg bones and muscles, a person lifting light weights or walking steadily.
 - **Closing:** Text overlay: “*Move more. Live longer. Start now.*”
-

APA-Style Reference List

Banach, M., et al. (2023). Each 1,000-step increment linked to a 15 percent reduction in all-cause mortality. *European Journal of Preventive Cardiology*. Retrieved from [Academic source]

CDC. (2024). Regular physical activity helps lower your cancer risk. In *Physical Activity Basics – Health Benefits*. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. Retrieved from [CDC]

Del Pozo Cruz, B., et al. (2022). Associations of daily steps with cancer, cardiovascular disease, and mortality. *JAMA Internal Medicine*, 182(7), 703–714.

Ding, D., et al. (2025). 7,000 steps per day linked to a 47 percent reduction in mortality risk. *The Lancet Public Health*.

Exercise. (2025). *Wikipedia*. Retrieved August 2025.

McTiernan, A. (2019). Physical activity in cancer prevention and survival. *Journal of Clinical Oncology*, 37(34), 2907–2914.

NIHR Evidence. (2023). Small amounts of exercise protect against early death, heart disease and cancer. National Institute for Health and Care Research.

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. (2018). *Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans, 2nd edition*.

Why This Setup Works

- **Voiceover Text** is clear, smooth, and ready for the narrator—no jargon, no visual-only info.
- **Visual Cue Instructions** give the animator clear timing and content for on-screen graphics—complementing, not repeating, the voiceover.
- **References** are formatted for easy copying into documentation or credits.
- **Tone and transitions** are consistent and audience-friendly—especially suited for health promotion and education.

Script: “Power Up with Healthy Proteins”

Narrator (welcoming tone):

Hey again. In this video, we’re going to discuss one of the main components of your everyday meals: **protein**.

Protein is essential — it helps us build muscle, repair our cell tissues, support our immune system, and stay strong during recovery^{1,2}!

And proteins come in all different forms, but they don’t ***always*** support your health in the same way. So, let’s take a closer look at how to choose the **best** options for your next meal!

Let’s start with the basics — what exactly *is* protein?

Protein is a nutrient found in many foods. And it’s important because it gives your body the building blocks it needs to repair and maintain your muscles, fight off illnesses, and keep you feeling strong.

Think of protein as your body’s repair crew. It strengthens muscles, fixes everyday wear and tear, and helps your body stay resilient and energized!

We can choose to get our protein from **animal** or **plant** sources, or a combination of both, but some sources are **healthier** than others.

So..which proteins should we focus on?

According to the **Dietary Guidelines for Americans**, the healthier protein choices are ¹:

- **Seafood**, like salmon or tuna
- **Poultry**, like chicken or turkey
- **Beans, peas, and lentils**
- **Soy products**, like tofu
- **Nuts and seeds**, including nut butters
- **Eggs**
- **And low-fat dairy**, like Greek yogurt or cottage cheese

These foods are rich in protein and also offer healthy fats, vitamins, minerals, and fiber¹

Next, let’s talk about some proteins we should try to **limit or avoid.**

- **First, red meats** like , pork, and lamb
- **And processed meats** like bacon, sausage, ham, and deli meats

Overeating of these meats has been linked to a higher risk of **colorectal cancer** and other chronic diseases like cardiovascular disease and type 2 diabetes.¹

The Dietary **Guidelines for Americans recommend** limiting red meat and **avoiding processed meats** as much as possible.¹

💡 **Ok, so we know which proteins to target and which to avoid. But How Much Protein Do We Actually Need?**

Well, adults between the ages of 18 and 59 should consume approximately **5 to 7 ounce-equivalents** of protein per day, depending on their individual recommended caloric intake.¹

And adults aged 60 and older should consume approximately 5 to 6.5 ounce-equivalents of protein per day, depending on their individual recommended caloric intake.¹ Everyone is different, and we all have different dietary needs, make sure to talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian nutritionist to find what's best for you.

And to give you an idea of what a single ounce-equivalent looks like...let's review some examples together. **One ounce-equivalent is the same as:**

- 1 egg
- ¼ cup of cooked beans or tofu
- 1 tablespoon of peanut butter
- 1 ounce of cooked poultry, fish, or meat
- Or ½ ounce of nuts or seeds

To get the most benefit, aim to **mix it up!** And don't forget to aim for **more plant-based proteins** and **less red and processed meat.** ¹

🥗 **Lastly, if you need some easy ways to sneak more healthy proteins into your everyday routine, try these quick tips!**

- Add beans or lentils to soups, salads, or tacos
- Swap red meat for grilled chicken or fish
- Use nut butter as a snack or breakfast boost
- Add seeds like chia or sunflower to oatmeal, yogurt, or smoothies!

👏 Choosing healthy proteins helps **fuel your body, protect your body,** and **support recovery.** By making simple swaps — like beans instead of beef, or grilled salmon instead of sausage — you're giving your body the tools it needs to stay strong and thrive.

Sit Less & Stand Up for Your Health

Opening Paragraph

Voiceover: “Have you noticed how much of your day is spent sitting—whether you’re watching TV, scrolling through your phone, or working at a desk? That’s what’s known as *sedentary behavior*—any waking activity where you’re sitting, reclining, or lying down while using very little energy. Modern conveniences, like grocery delivery and desk-based work, make it easy to stay still—and in fact, many people spend up to a third of their waking hours sitting” (Patterson et al., 2018).

On-screen text cues:

- *Sedentary behavior = sitting, reclining, or lying down while awake*
 - *Up to 1/3 of your day*
-

Health Impacts Paragraphs

Voiceover:

“Sitting for six to eight hours a day—or more—raises your risk of serious heart issues or early death, regardless of how much you exercise (Patterson et al., 2018). It also slows down your metabolism, making it harder to process sugar and more likely to lead to fat buildup—especially around the belly—while weakening your muscles and bones (Li, 2022).”

On-screen text cues (short headlines or key phrases):

- *Higher risk of heart problems & early death*
- *Slows your metabolism • Difficult to process sugar • Belly fat & muscle loss*

Voiceover:

“Extended sitting has also been linked to higher chances of developing certain cancers, such as colon, endometrial, and breast cancer (Park et al., 2020), and weakens muscles and bones further, increasing the risk of falls, fractures, and osteoporosis (Park et al., 2020). There’s also a mental toll: too much sitting contributes to fatigue, feeling low, and poor mental well-being (Tremblay et al., 2011).”

On-screen text cues:

- *Increased cancer risk (colon, endometrial, breast)*
 - *Weaker muscles & bones → Falls & fractures*
 - *Mental health impact: fatigue, low mood*
-

Tips Paragraph

Voiceover:

“Adding small bursts of movement into your day can make a difference. At work, try standing or walking every 30 minutes, taking the stairs, or standing during phone calls. During your commute, if you’re on public transit—stand, get off one stop early, or park farther away for extra steps. At home, use TV commercials to do light moves like loading the dishwasher or kneeling, or substitute screen time with a walk, yoga, or gentle seated exercises like arm circles or knee lifts.”

On-screen text cues:

- *Work: Stand/walk every 30 min • Take stairs • Stand on calls*
 - *Commute: Stand • Walk one stop early • Park farther away*
 - *Home: Move during ads • Seated exercises • Swap screen time*
-

Conclusion Paragraph

Voiceover: “Every time you stand up or stretch, you’re taking a meaningful step toward better health. It doesn’t have to be big—just start moving today, one small change at a time.”

On-screen text cue (closing message):

“Move more. Sit less. Feel better.”

APA-Style Reference List

- Li, D. (2022). Sedentary lifestyle and body composition in type 2 diabetes. *Diabetology & Metabolic Syndrome*, 14, Article 78.
- Park, J. H., et al. (2020). Sedentary lifestyle: Overview of updated evidence. *Korean Journal of Family Medicine*, 41(4), 207–214.
- Patterson, R., McNamara, E., Tainio, M., de Sá, T. H., Smith, A. D., Sharp, S. J., ... Wijndaele, K. (2018). Sedentary behaviour and risk of all-cause, cardiovascular, and cancer mortality, and incident type 2 diabetes: A systematic review and dose-response meta-analysis. *European Journal of Epidemiology*, 33(9), 811–829. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10654-018-0380-1>
- Tremblay, M. S., et al. (2011). Systematic review of sedentary behaviour and health indicators in school-aged children and youth. *International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity*.

Animation #19: Stress: The Good and the Bad

Narrator: Welcome to today's session on stress awareness and management. Today, we're going to explore what stress is, how it impacts us, and how to start managing it in a healthy way.

Let's start with a basic definition. The National Cancer Institute defines stress as the body's response to physical, mental, or emotional pressures—often called *stressors* ([Source](#)).

Stress can come from major life events like illness or trauma, but it also shows up in everyday situations, such as:

- Work-related demands
- Financial concerns
- Family tension
- Or even small choices—like deciding what to cook for dinner

You may be wondering, is all stress bad?

Actually, no—and that's an important distinction.

Some stress is good. It's called *eustress*—the kind of stress that motivates us or brings excitement.

Think about the stress of exercising: it challenges your body, but leads to better health over time. Or the nerves before a big presentation that push you to prepare and succeed. That's *eustress* in action.

But when stress starts to feel overwhelming or harmful, we call it *distress*. This is the kind of stress that wears us down and negatively impacts our health and well-being.

Now, does the length of time we experience stress matter?

Yes, absolutely.

- Acute stress happens over short periods—like a traffic jam or a disagreement. It's intense but usually fades once the situation resolves.
- Chronic stress, on the other hand, sticks around. It can last weeks, months, or longer if we don't have good ways to cope.

And chronic stress is linked to serious health issues like anxiety, depression, high blood pressure, and heart disease.

How does stress affect the body?

Stress doesn't just stay in your head—it shows up in many parts of your life:

- **Thinking:** Trouble focusing, racing thoughts, forgetfulness
- **Emotions:** Irritability, restlessness, sadness or depression
- **Behaviors:** Sleep problems, procrastination, changes in appetite or substance use
- **Physical symptoms:** Muscle tension, headaches, chest pain
- **Social life:** Withdrawing from others or avoiding support

What's happening inside our body when we feel stressed?

Stress activates the *fight-or-flight* response—a survival mechanism designed to help us respond to threats. When this happens, our body reacts with:

- A faster heart rate and quickened breathing
- Increased blood pressure
- Tense muscles
- Dilated pupils for sharper vision

This can be helpful in the short term. But if this response is constantly active, it starts to take a toll—leading to:

- Anxiety or depression
- Digestive problems like indigestion or heartburn
- Trouble sleeping
- Headaches
- Unwanted weight gain

So, what can we do about it?

The first step in managing stress is *awareness*.

We all experience different types and sources of stress, and there are many ways one can cope with stress. Some healthier than others.

So, for this reason, learning to recognize the types and sources of stressors and how your body reacts to them is key to creating appropriate solutions.

And look, sometimes we have to try many different things to find the right fit for us.

And as you now know, stress is a normal part of life—but when it becomes chronic, it can affect our mental, emotional, physical, and social health.

Check out our video guide to create simple ways to manage stress and build resilience.

Thanks for joining today. And remember: *awareness is the first step toward change*.

Additional References:

[Chronic stress puts your health at risk - Mayo Clinic](#)

3.24.25

Welcome to Today's Session on Stress Awareness and Management

Today, we'll be exploring stress: what it is, how it affects us, and ways to manage it effectively.

[Do not say] What is Stress?

The National Cancer Institute defines stress as the body's response to physical, mental, or emotional pressures or stressors.

Stress can be caused by everyday life activities or by an event, such as trauma or illness like cancer or heart disease.

Stress can also arise from:

- Work-related demands
- Financial challenges
- Family conflict
- Even everyday decisions, like what to have for dinner

Is all stress bad?

In short, no. Stress can be good, this is called eustress.

Eustress promotes healthy feelings and behaviors. Examples include the stress of exercising, which strengthens the body over time, or the excitement of achieving a goal, such as being recognized at work.

On the other hand, bad stress is called distress, and this occurs when a situation negatively impacts our health or well-being.

Does it matter if stress is over a short or long period of time?

Yes, it does. Stress that is over short-periods of time is also called acute stress. Acute stress is caused by events like arguments, deadlines, or being stuck in traffic. This type of stress usually subsides once the situation is resolved.

Long-term stress is commonly referred to as chronic stress.

Chronic stress persists for weeks or more without proper coping or healthy ways to deal with that stress. Chronic stress increases the risk of anxiety, depression, hypertension, and heart disease.

Now, talk about how stress affects our body.

Stress can manifest in multiple ways, affecting our:

- **Cognition or ability to think:** Resulting in poor concentration, racing thoughts, or difficulty remembering
- **It can impact our emotions,** where over time it can lead to irritability, restlessness, or depression
- **It can affect our behavior:** leading to sleep problems, avoidance of tasks, or changes in eating and drinking habits
- **It can present itself physically leading to** muscle aches, headaches, or chest pain
- **And have a negative impact on our social life,** where stress can lead us to isolate ourselves from others

When we encounter stress, our body activates the “**fight-or-flight**” response. You may have heard about this before, but this is a survival mechanism we have that is designed to help us handle threats. When we go into a fight or flight response, our body experiences:

- Rapid heart rate and breathing
- Increased blood pressure
- Dilated pupils for improved vision
- Muscle tension for action

However, long-term activation of fight and flight response can disrupt our body’s processes and put us at risk for adverse health effects, such as:

- Anxiety
- Depression
- Headaches
- Indigestion or heartburn
- Sleep problems
- Weight gain¹

Recognizing these signs early is essential for preventing stress from worsening.

The first to deal with our stress is to be able to recognize our stressors, or in other words develop what is known as “stress awareness”

The first step in managing stress is becoming familiar with the sources of stress and how your body reacts to them.

What is important to remember is that stress is a natural part of life, but chronic stress can have negative effects on your mental, emotional, physical, and social well-being, so it’s essential to manage our stress.

In another video, we’ll explore practical strategies for managing stress. Thank you for joining today’s discussion today, and remember: awareness is the first step toward finding solutions to address those stressors.

References:

1. [Chronic stress puts your health at risk - Mayo Clinic](#)

Today we will be looking at stress. Stress, by definition, is our ability or inability to respond to some form of demand in life. This can be related to many things, such as:

- Work-related
- Finances
- Family conflict
- Getting positive feedback.
- Maybe, deciding what to have for dinner.
- Receiving your test results back

While we think all stress is bad, there are different types of stress. The first type of stress is "Eustress," or good stress. This type of stress in our lives promotes healthy feelings and behaviors. When you exercise, you are applying stress to the body to eventually adapt to the movement. Over time, you become healthier and stronger. Good stress can also happen when you spend time with your family, receive good feedback from your healthcare team, or even be recognized at work. These experiences foster healthy emotions that motivate us to keep working toward our goals.

When we think about the word "Stress," we link it to the term "Distress". This type of stress occurs when a negative situation impacts our emotions, actions, and health status. There are two types: Acute and Chronic.

Acute stress is short-term stress that occurs from one event. Our feelings of being stress may last from a couple of seconds to a week. Things like:

- Driving in traffic
- Being in an argument
- Work load

All can cause us to be stressed in the short-term. It's important to remember that this type of stress easily leaves as we learn how to cope (that's in our next video).

However, allowing our stress to linger for weeks without coping can evolve into "Chronic Stress", or long-term stress. Research shows that long-term stress is a risk factor for other diseases, like:

- Depression
- Anxiety
- Obesity
- Hypertension
- Cancer

To prevent your stress from lingering and worsening, it is crucial to ensure we recognize it early. You can do this by writing out what are those things in life that stress you out. That way you can be ready to act when those things happen.

Next, we can note what is going on in our body. During a stressful moment, our body releases cortisol, which makes us go into "fight or flight" mode. When this is released, our body wants to either deal with the stress now or avoid the stressor. This can cause the body to react by increasing your:

- heart rate
- breathing rate
- blood pressure
- muscle tension

And other sensations, as you can see on the screen. You may notice your mood change, causing you to be irritable, sad, tired, or even depressed. It's important to remember how you physical or emotionally respond to stress because it can prevent us from dealing with stress in an unhealthy way.

As you can see, stress can come from many things in life. Taking a proactive approach to prevent stress can help you live a healthy life. Watch the next video to learn how to manage your stress.

Time: 2 min 43 sec

Score: 8.989

Healthy Buckeyes: Stress Management Techniques (≈3 min Animation Script)

[Opening Scene – soft ambient background music; slow wave or light particle motion]

Narrator:

Stress is part of life — and for cancer survivors and caregivers, it can sometimes feel even heavier.

The good news is that there are evidence-based tools you can use to manage stressful moments, support your emotional and physical health, and feel more in control.

[Visual: title appears — “Three Proven Stress-Reduction Techniques” — with three icons: 🧘 breathing, 🧘 mindfulness, 🧘 muscle relaxation.]

Narrator:

In this short video, we’ll explore three simple techniques you can do anywhere, anytime:

1. Diaphragmatic (“Boxed”) Breathing
2. Mindful Meditation
3. Progressive Muscle Relaxation

Let’s start with the first one.

1. Diaphragmatic (Boxed) Breathing

[Visual: zoom into the breathing icon; gentle blue tones; slow expansion and contraction of abstract lungs.]

Narrator:

This first exercise only takes a few minutes, and you can do it almost anywhere — sitting at your desk, in a waiting room, or before bed.

You don’t need anything special — just a little time and your breath.

Let’s try it together.

Place one hand on your chest and the other on your belly.

Breathe in through your nose for four seconds ... hold for four ... exhale gently through your mouth for four ... then pause for four.

That's one "box."

You'll notice your belly rise and fall while your chest stays mostly still — that's your diaphragm working.

Even a few slow cycles like this can calm your heart rate and lower blood pressure by activating your body's natural relaxation response

(Brown & Gerbarg, 2005; Jerath et al., 2006).

[Visual cue: return to main screen; breathing icon softly glows.]

2. Mindful Meditation

[Visual: zoom into mindfulness icon; warm golden tones; animation of gentle light surrounding a seated silhouette.]

Narrator:

Now, let's talk about **mindful meditation** — something to try when you have a little more time to slow down.

You may have heard of mindfulness through apps like **Calm**, **Headspace**, or even playlists on **Spotify** and **Apple Music**.

It's about **being present**, on purpose, and without judgment.

Find a comfortable position.

Bring your attention to your breath, or the sensations in your body.

When your mind wanders — and it will — simply notice that, and gently bring it back to the present moment.

Practicing mindfulness regularly can reduce anxiety, improve focus, and support emotional resilience — even in people coping with serious illness

(Goyal et al., 2014; Carlson et al., 2017).

[Visual cue: soft chime; return to main screen; mindfulness icon glows.]

3. Progressive Muscle Relaxation (PMR)

[Visual: zoom into muscle icon; soothing violet tones; animated body outline highlighting muscle groups from feet to head.]

Narrator:

Finally, let's explore **progressive muscle relaxation**, or PMR.

This technique helps you notice where tension lives in your body — and teaches you how to release it.

You can sit or lie down comfortably.

Start with your feet: gently tense the muscles as you breathe in ... hold a moment ... then release completely as you breathe out.

Move upward — calves, thighs, stomach, shoulders, and face — one area at a time.

You'll start to sense how your body feels when it's tense versus relaxed.

Practiced regularly, PMR can lower anxiety, improve sleep, and even help reduce blood pressure

(Jacobson, 1938; Pawlow & Jones, 2002; Calderone et al., 2025).

[Visual cue: return to main screen; all three icons now softly glowing.]



Conclusion

[Visual: survivor smiling, connecting with loved ones, sunlight through trees.]

Narrator:

Managing stress isn't about perfection — it's about small, steady moments of care.

Each mindful breath, each relaxed muscle, each moment of awareness helps your body and mind recover.

Start with one technique that feels right for you today — maybe a few breaths, a short meditation, or a few minutes of muscle relaxation.

You've already shown so much strength and courage.

Remember, you're not alone — and every small step toward calm truly makes a difference.

[Fade out with gentle music; closing screen: “Healthy Buckeyes – Supporting Survivors and Caregivers.”]



References (APA 7th Edition)

- Brown, R. P., & Gerbarg, P. L. (2005). Sudarshan Kriya yogic breathing in the treatment of stress, anxiety, and depression: Part I—Neurophysiologic model. *Journal of Alternative and Complementary Medicine*, 11(1), 189–201.
- Calderone, F., et al. (2025). *Effectiveness of relaxation techniques for stress management and quality of life improvement in cardiovascular disease and hypertensive patients: A systematic review. Psychology, Health & Medicine.*
- Carlson, L. E., Tamagawa, R., Stephen, J., Drysdale, E., & Speca, M. (2017). Randomized controlled trial of mindfulness-based cancer recovery versus supportive expressive group therapy for distressed survivors of breast cancer. *Journal of Clinical Oncology*, 35(29), 3681–3689.
- Goyal, M., Singh, S., Sibinga, E. M. S., et al. (2014). Meditation programs for psychological stress and well-being: A systematic review and meta-analysis. *JAMA Internal Medicine*, 174(3), 357–368.
- Jacobson, E. (1938). *Progressive Relaxation*. University of Chicago Press.
- Jerath, R., Edry, J. W., Barnes, V. A., & Jerath, V. (2006). Physiology of long pranayamic breathing: Neural respiratory elements may provide a mechanism that explains how slow deep breathing shifts the autonomic nervous system. *Medical Hypotheses*, 67(3), 566–571.

- Pawlow, L. A., & Jones, G. E. (2002). The impact of abbreviated progressive muscle relaxation on salivary cortisol. *Biological Psychology*, 60(1), 1–16.
-

Would you like me to create the **animation scene breakdown** next — including timing (seconds), visual transitions, and suggested color palette for each technique — so your animator has everything ready for storyboarding?

Introduction

Narrator:

Stress is part of life — and for cancer survivors and caregivers, it can sometimes feel even heavier.

The good news is that simple, proven tools can help you manage stress and support your well-being. In this short video, we'll explore practical habits that help you feel more in control, connected, and at peace.

Healthy Lifestyle Choices

[Visual: colorful meals, gentle walk outdoors, friends laughing**]**

Narrator:

Some of our daily choices can help reduce stress and lift our mood. Like...

- Eating a balanced, nourishing diet
- Moving your body in ways you enjoy
- Staying socially connected

These 3 habits can have a real impact on our day-to-day life.

The American Cancer Society recommends healthy eating and regular activity for everyone — and for survivors and caregivers, strong social support can ease emotional distress and boost quality of life.

Cognitive-Behavioral Strategies

Narrator:

Stressful moments often bring negative thoughts — but you can learn to respond differently.

Start by noticing what you tell yourself when you're overwhelmed. Then, reframe it.

Instead of *"I can't handle this,"* try *"This feels hard, but I've handled tough things before — I can find a way forward."*

Stress-Reduction Techniques

[Visual: calming animation of each practice**]**

Narrator:

Let's go over three simple techniques to calm your mind and body:

1. Diaphragmatic Breathing, sometimes called belly breathing¹

Place one hand on your chest and the other on your belly.

Inhale through your nose for six seconds, hold briefly, then exhale slowly through your mouth. Just a few deep breaths can signal your body that you're safe.

2. Mindful Movement

Take a short walk, stretch, or do gentle yoga.

Focus on your breath, your muscles, and how your body feels.

This helps release tension and quiet your thoughts.

3. Guided Imagery

Pause and imagine a peaceful place — maybe sitting by the ocean or walking through a quiet forest.

Let yourself feel the calm of that moment.

Mindfulness isn't about emptying your mind — it's about noticing thoughts, then gently returning to the present.

Conclusion

[Visual: survivor smiling, connecting with loved ones, feeling relaxed**]**

Narrator:

Managing stress isn't about perfection — it's about small, consistent moments of care.

As a survivor or a caregiver, you've already shown so much strength and courage.

Each deep breath, each moment of calm, helps build resilience.

Start with one or two techniques that feel right for you — and remember, you're not alone on this journey. Every small step you take truly makes a difference.

References:

1. [Effectiveness of diaphragmatic breathing for reducing physiological and psychological stress in adults: a quantitative systematic review - PubMed](#)

Stress Management Techniques

Introduction

Narrator:

Stress is a part of life—and for cancer survivors, it can feel even more difficult at times.

But there's good news: many **simple, proven tools** can help you manage stress and support your well-being.

Today, we'll walk through practical strategies and healthy habits that can help you feel more in control, connected, and at peace. Let's get started.

Healthy Lifestyle Choices

[Visual: Split screen showing colorful, balanced meals, a person walking outdoors, and friends chatting and laughing]

Narrator:

Your lifestyle choices don't just support physical recovery—they also play a powerful role in reducing stress and boosting your mood. Three key areas can make a big difference:

- **Eating a balanced, nourishing diet**
- **Staying physically active with movement you enjoy**
- **And maintaining supportive social connections**

The American Cancer Society recommends healthy eating and regular physical activity not just for cancer survivors, but for everyone.¹ And having strong social support from family, friends, and even cancer support groups, can ease emotional distress. Talking with someone who truly understands your journey can be incredibly validating and uplifting.

Cognitive-Behavioral Strategies

Narrator:

Stressful situations often trigger negative thoughts—but you can flip the script and learn to respond differently. That's where cognitive behavioral strategies come in, let's dive in:

- **First, notice your stressful thoughts:** What do you tell yourself when you feel overwhelmed?
- **Gently challenge and reframe these thoughts:** For example, replace “I can't handle this” with “This feels hard, but I've handled tough things before. I can make a plan and find a way forward.”

Research even shows that **cognitive-behavioral stress management (CBSM)** programs after treatment can reduce depression and improve quality of life for survivors, even years after treatment.²

Stress Reduction Techniques

[Visual: Calming animation showing each technique being practiced step-by-step]

Narrator:

So we've covered ways to think through our stress and flip our mindset, but let's review some mindful practices that help calm the mind and body.

Let's go over **three** simple, powerful techniques you can use any time you notice stress starting to build:

Number 1, Belly Breathing:

- Place one hand on your chest and the other on your belly
- Inhale through your nose for 6 seconds.....—feel your belly rise
- Hold for 7 seconds....
- Exhale slowly for 8 seconds...
- And repeat 3–5 times or however long you need

This helps calm your nervous system and signals to your body that you're safe.

Number 2, Mindful Movement:

- Choose a calming activity you enjoy, like walking, stretching, or gentle yoga
- Pay close attention to how your body feels as you move
- Notice your breath, your muscles, your surroundings

Mindful movement reduces stress hormones and helps you feel more grounded.

And lastly, number 3, Guided Imagery:

- Pause and notice: What do I see? Hear? Feel? Smell? Taste?
- You might also close your eyes and imagine a peaceful scene—like sitting near the ocean or walking through a quiet forest

This technique brings your attention to the present moment, easing anxious thoughts and calming your mind.

Mindfulness is not about “emptying your mind”—it’s about gently noticing your thoughts and returning your attention to the present. Over time, these small moments of mindfulness can create a lasting sense of peace and resilience.

Conclusion

[Visual: A survivor practicing the techniques, smiling and interacting with loved ones, looking peaceful and confident]

Narrator:

Managing stress doesn’t require perfection—it just takes practice, patience, and the willingness to try.

As a cancer survivor, you’ve already shown incredible strength. Every time you take a deep breath, ask for support, or pause to care for yourself—you’re building **resilience**.

Start with one or two techniques that feel doable. Then build from there.

Remember, you’re not alone on this journey—and **every small step you take makes a difference**.

Food Label Claims

Narrator:

Hey there, shoppers! Ever feel overwhelmed by all the claims on food labels? From “all natural” to “multi-grain,” it can be hard to know what to trust. But don’t worry—we’re here to help you make sense of these claims so you can choose healthier options with confidence.

Narrator:

Let’s head into the aisles and break down some of the most common claims you’ll see—and what they *really* mean.

Narrator:

One label you’ll see everywhere is “*all natural*.” Sounds wholesome, right? But what does it really mean?

Well, there’s no official definition, and it’s not strictly regulated. Products labeled “all natural” can still contain chemicals, preservatives, and even synthetic ingredients.

Narrator:

So, what does this mean for you?

“All natural” on a label doesn’t necessarily mean healthy. Fresh fruits and vegetables—often without labels—are the truly natural, healthy choices! For packaged foods, check the ingredient list. Look for products where vegetables, fruits, or whole grains are the *first* ingredient and that are low in added sugars. Those are the real winners for your cart.

Narrator:

Next, let’s tackle the sweet stuff—claims like “*sugar-free*,” “*reduced sugar*,” or “*no added sugar*.” These sound straightforward, but there’s more to the story.

- “Sugar-free” means less than 0.5 grams of sugar per serving, but that doesn’t mean no sweeteners! Ingredients like honey, corn syrup, or cane juice may still be present.
- “Reduced sugar” means at least 25% less sugar than the regular version.
- “No added sugar” means that no sugar was added during processing.

Narrator:

Artificial sweeteners, often used in “sugar-free” products, were designed to replace sugar, but research suggests they can disrupt gut health, affect blood sugar control, and even lead to eating more calories over time.

And cutting back on added sugars aligns with cancer prevention recommendations to limit or avoid sugar-sweetened beverages.

Narrator:

And here’s a quick tip: a teaspoon of sugar equals 4 grams. So if a soda has 40 grams of added sugar, that’s 10 teaspoons! Instead, try drinks with little or no added sugar, like fresh fruit-infused water .

Narrator:

Moving on, what about when something says “*low-fat*”? It might sound like a healthier choice—but there’s an important twist.

“Low-fat” means 3 grams of fat or less per serving, and when food items are labeled as low fat they tend to make up for lost flavor by adding sugar or artificial ingredients. Always check the ingredient list and nutrition facts to see the full picture.

Narrator:

Another claim you've probably seen is "*made with real fruit*." It sounds reassuring, but don't let the wording fool you. This one can be tricky. It might mean there's only a small amount of actual fruit or just some fruit juice concentrate. To make sure you're getting real fruit benefits, check that fruit is listed near the top of the ingredient list.

Narrator:

Now let's head to the bread and cereal aisle. "*Multi-grain*" is a popular claim—but does it mean what you think it does? While "Multi-grain" sounds healthy, it only means a mix of different grains—and not necessarily whole grains. For better nutrition and more fiber, look for the Whole Grains Council's 100% stamp or check the ingredients list for "whole grain" as the first ingredient.

Narrator:

As a rule of thumb, aim to make at least half your grains whole grains. If water is listed first, "whole grain" should be second, and if there are multiple whole grains, they should appear near the top of the list.

Narrator:

Finally, let's clear up claims like "good source of" or "high in" a nutrient.

- "Good source of" means the food has 10–19% of your daily value of a nutrient, like fiber, vitamin D, or calcium.
- "High" or "excellent source of" means 20% or more of your daily value—a better pick if you're looking for a nutrient boost.

Narrator:

And there you have it! Understanding these common food label claims will help you make smarter, healthier choices and see through the marketing. Next time you're at the supermarket, let these tips be your guide.

Happy shopping—and we'll see you next time!

- Sources:

- <https://www.fda.gov/food/food-labeling-nutrition/label-claims-conventional-foods-and-dietary-supplements>
 - There are three types of claims that are allowed to be used on both food and dietary supplement packaging/labels that are defined by statutes or FDA regulations. These are health claims, nutrient content claims, and structure/function claims.
 - What are health claims?: Describe relationship between a food substance and a reduced risk of a disease or health-related condition. Has two essential components: (1) a substance (food, food component or ingredient) and (2) disease or health-related condition.
 - What are nutrient content claims?: Claims that characterize the level of nutrient in a food if they have been authorized by FDA and made in accordance with FDA authorizing regulation and can include terms like free, high, and low to describe a level of nutrient in a food or use terms like more, reduced, lite in comparing the level of nutrient in a food to that of another food. For example, a statement such as "only 200 mg of sodium" characterizes the level of sodium by implying that it is low. Therefore, the food would have to meet the nutritional criteria for a "low" nutrient content claim or carry a disclosure statement that it does not qualify for the claim (e.g., "not a low sodium food"). The requirements that govern the use of nutrient content claims help ensure that descriptive terms, such as high or low, are used consistently for all types of food products and are thus meaningful to consumers. Healthy is an implied nutrient content claim that characterizes a food as having "healthy" levels of total fat, saturated fat, cholesterol and sodium, as defined in the regulation authorizing use of the claim.
 - What are structure/function claims?: They may describe the role of a nutrient or dietary ingredient intended to affect the normal structure or function of the human body (i.e. calcium builds strong bones) or can characterize the way a nutrient or dietary ingredient acts to maintain such structure or function (i.e. fiber maintains bowel regularity)
- <https://www.webmd.com/diet/read-nutrition-label>
 - Common Food Claims
 - i. Organic: The National Organic Program (NOP) within the USDA is responsible for regulating the organic label. Organic is shown through a green and white label.
 - ii. Made with Organic: At least 70% of that ingredient must be organic but the label for organic is not used.
 - iii. Gluten-free: important for those with celiac disease or gluten sensitivity, but no official FDA symbol, but you can generally trust the labels
 - iv. Cage Free vs Free Range vs Organic: Can be seen on labels for eggs, poultry and meats. Cage free: Hens are still in closed space, but some room to walk around. Free range: Access to outdoors, but may be fenced Organic: Grown and raised in soil free of synthetic fertilizers and pesticides/allowed to roam and graze on pastures and are also fed organic feed with not antibiotics or hormones. Organic eggs are from free-range hens raised on organic feed.
 - v. Wild Caught vs Farm Raised: In terms of sea food, the wild-caught is seafood in lakes, oceans or bodies of water while farm is in tanks or net cages off shore.
 - Some food claims will be on packaging, but will lack official definitions so watch out for these!
 - i. Lightly sweetened: No definition exists from the FDA about a low sugar claim so that is not allowed, but companies will go around this by using similar, but not exactly the same statements like lightly sweetened or slightly sweet, but it is best to look at the nutrition facts label to see how much added sugars are added.
 - ii. Healthy: This is currently being updated by the FDA, but for now, a healthy claim can be made if the fats in their foods are mostly mono- and polyunsaturated fats. The healthy claim also can be used on products that have at least 10% of the Daily Value of potassium and vitamin D.
 - iii. Natural: (<https://www.fda.gov/food/food-labeling-nutrition/use-term-natural-food-labeling>) There is currently no official definition, so be cautious. In general, the FDA does consider natural to mean "nothing artificial or synthetic (including all color additives regardless of source) has been included in, or has been added to, a food that would not normally be expected to be in that food." Production methods are not covered or pesticides.
 - iv. Humanely-Raised: Not a term regulated by FDA. There may be third-party certifications for this.
 - v. Hormone free: While all animals already have hormones, any added hormones are not legal and are banned in poultry, veal, eggs, bison, and pork, but for dairy, beef, or lamb look for the no added hormones instead.
- <https://open.maricopa.edu/nutritionessentials/chapter/chapter-4-understanding-food-labels-health-claims/>
 - Common nutrition content claims seen on nutrition label packaging
 - i. Low-fat: means 3 or less grams of fat
 - ii. Low salt: less than 140 mg of sodium • Low cholesterol: less than 20 mg and 2 g sat. Fat
 - iii. Lean: for a specific type of meat, there is less than a set amount of grams of fat for it
 - iv. High: contains more than 20% of that specific nutrients daily value
 - v. Good source: contains 10 to 19% of the nutrients daily value
 - vi. Light: contains 1/3 fewer calories or 50% less fat and if more than half of calories are from fat, the fat content must be reduced by half or more
 - vii. Organic: Contains 95% organic ingredients
- <https://www.heart.org/en/healthy-living/healthy-eating/eat-smart/nutrition-basics/food-packaging-claims>
 - Some common food claims:
 - i. Sugar free: less than 0.5 gram sugar and no ingredient that is a sugar
 - ii. Reduced or less sugar: at least 25% less sugars than regular product
 - iii. No added sugar: no sugar added during processing or packaging
 - iv. Low calorie: 40 cal or less
 - v. Reduced calorie: at least 25% less calories than reg product
 - vi. Calorie free: less than 5 calories
 - vii. Lean: less than 10 g fat, 4.5 g sat fat and 95 mg of cholesterol
 - viii. High fiber or excellent source of fiber: 20% more of Daily value for fiber
 - ix. Good source of fiber: 10-19% of Daily Value for fiber
 - x. No salt added: No salt added during processing

- xi. Low sodium: 140 mg or less
 - xii. Reduced sodium: at least 25% less sodium than reg product
- <https://www.canr.msu.edu/resources/food-label-claims>
 - Where do food label claims originate?
 - i. Government like FDA and USDA
 - ii. Third-Party o Used: to enhance understanding and credibility of food attributes and each org has own set of criteria and verification or certification standards
 - iii. Producers or Food Manufacturers
- <https://wholegrainscouncil.org/whole-grain-stamp>
 - If a product bears the 100% Stamp (left image below), then all its grain ingredients are whole grain. There is a minimum requirement of 16g (16 grams) – a full serving – of whole grain per labeled serving, for products using the 100% Stamp.

Animation Script: The BRAT Diet

Length: ~2 minutes

Narrator:

Cancer and cancer treatments can lead to gastrointestinal, or GI, symptoms such as diarrhea, constipation, nausea, or stomach discomfort. These symptoms can occur at any stage of your cancer journey, and choosing foods that feel tolerable can be difficult. So, let's talk about one approach that you can apply to eat when your stomach doesn't feel at its best.

pause Let's talk about the BRAT diet, a short-term eating plan, which is used to help calm the stomach when experiencing GI symptoms.

Narrator:

So, what does BRAT stand for?

BRAT stands for **Bananas, Rice, Applesauce, and Toast**. These foods are low in fiber, low in fat, and generally easy to digest, making it easy on your stomach.

The BRAT diet is recommended for **short-term** purposes to help reduce stool frequency and ease digestive irritation. It's important to know that following this diet, is **not** designed to meet long-term nutritional needs.

Narrator:

Let's talk about how the BRAT diet is helpful for an upset stomach.

"B", Bananas are soft and easy to digest and provide potassium, an electrolyte that may be lost with frequent diarrhea.

"R", Rice, try some plain white rice, as this is low in fiber and can help make stools firmer.

"A", Applesauce offers carbohydrates without the insoluble fiber found in raw apples, making it easier for your body to digest.

And lastly, "T", Toast, is bland, and also low in fiber, and often well tolerated when the gut is sensitive.

These foods are chosen because they are easy to digest, or in other words, our stomach doesn't have to work so hard.

Narrator:

The BRAT diet should only be used for a **short time, usually 24 to 48 hours**. It does not provide enough protein, healthy fats, fiber, or key vitamins over time to support the body. The purpose is to help alleviate short-term GI symptoms.

As symptoms improve, it is important to gradually add back other foods, such as lean proteins, healthy fats, and fiber, based on what your body can tolerate.

Narrator:

Digestive symptoms vary from person to person. If symptoms are persistent, severe, or worsening, contact your healthcare team or a registered dietitian.

Nutrition before, during, and after cancer is about finding what works best for *your* body, one bite, at a time.

Resources (2, Cleveland Clinic):

1. [What To Eat When You Have Diarrhea](#)
2. [BRAT Diet: What It Is and Foods To Eat](#)